

# THE ROADRUNNER'S GUIDE TO ENGLISH



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Book: The Roadrunner's Guide to English  
(Crisp et al.)

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## Licensing

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*A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).*

## CHAPTER OVERVIEW

### 1: Reading and Writing Process

1.1: Reading and Writing as Processes

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1.3: Drafting

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1.7: Unstated Main Idea

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## 1.1: Reading and Writing as Processes

While reading and writing well may seem like magic, each is actually a step-by-step process that anyone can learn. This section will walk you through the steps and give you some techniques for reading and writing in college that have helped many students much like you.

| Writing                                                                                                                                                           | Reading                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Planning to Write</li><li>• Drafting</li><li>• Editing and Revising</li><li>• Proofreading</li><li>• Publishing</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Planning to Read</li><li>• Survey</li><li>• Question</li><li>• Read</li><li>• Recite</li><li>• Review</li></ul> |

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## 1.2: Planning to Read or Write

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### How Do I Get Started Reading or Writing?

#### Writing

How do I get started?

The first step in writing is actually not writing at all. Before you can write well, you have to have something to say. So, the first step is to generate ideas that you will incorporate into your writing.

There are several strategies that students and professors alike use to help them come up with good ideas. These strategies work well for writing you do as an out-of-class assignment or for in-class writing; you'll simply spend more time if you're writing out of class. These strategies are brainstorming, freewriting, and clustering (also known as mapping).

For more detailed information on planning your writing, visit the Wikibooks - *Rhetoric and Composition* chapter, "Planning and Prewriting."

#### Reading

Before you start to read, preview the material. Note the section headings and any bold or italicized words. Next, jot down some questions you might have about the reading assignment. If you are reading about the American Revolutionary War, you might have the question, "What caused the war?" Now you are ready to read! Just be sure to be an active reader, someone who is truly paying attention to the ideas, not just someone who is looking at the words but not really understanding them. To make sure that you are an active reader, picture what is being said. If the material is about a battle, picture the battle and the fighting that occurs; don't just "think" the words. That way, you should find the answers to the questions you came up with before reading and remember what you have read. After you have read and answered the questions you prepared, go back over the questions and recite the answers. Finally, review the material. You want to make sure that you not only read the material, but that you also understood it!

#### SQR

The SQ3R method is a reading strategy that teaches the reader to: Survey, Question, Read, Recite, and Review.

To learn about this method, you may visit the websites below.

- SQ3R Handout - handout provided by the Borough of Manhattan Community College
- The SQ3R Reading Method - from the Study Guides and Strategies website

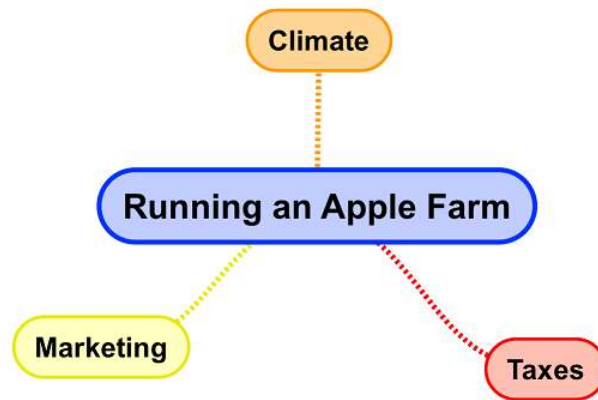
#### Brainstorming

Brainstorming is the planning method most often used for in-class, timed writing, but many students also like it for out-of-class writing as well. When you brainstorm, you look at your topic and start writing down ideas about that topic as soon as they occur to you. You don't worry about whether the ideas are good or bad; the point is just to generate ideas to choose from. If you're writing out of class with no time limit, you might brainstorm for five or ten minutes. For timed writing, most students will spend as few as two and no more than five minutes.

#### Clustering

Clustering is particularly useful for writers who like having a visual representation of their ideas. In this method, students write their topic in the center of a piece of paper and draw a circle around it. Then they put related, supporting ideas in a "cluster" around that central topic, drawing circles around the ideas and connecting them to the main idea or even each other with lines to show how they are related.

A simple cluster map of the essay about apples might look something like this:



*Figure 1.2.1*

## Freewriting

Freewriting is sometimes called the “wet ink” method of planning a piece of writing. In this method, you pick a period of time, often five to ten minutes, and you write complete sentences about your topic without pausing – without letting the ink get dry on the page. You don’t go back and make changes or corrections, you don’t worry about the quality of your ideas, and if you run out of ideas, you write “I can’t think what to write” until something comes to you. Again, the point is to generate ideas, although sometimes student writers find they can take whole sentences from their freewriting and put them directly into their papers.

## References

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## 1.3: Drafting

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### Writing the Paper

Once you've gotten into the habit of planning, you may well find that the actual writing of the essay is relatively easy. If you have the basic plan laid out, you can follow it as you explain your thoughts. You don't have to follow it in exact order, though. If you find it easier to start with one of the body paragraphs even though the introduction will ultimately be the first thing a reader sees, feel free. You can put everything in order later.

### Drafting Guidelines

1. Overview of Drafting
2. Drafting: The Process
3. During the Drafting Process
  1. Let It Flow
  2. Dealing with Writer's Block
  3. Experiment
  4. Meeting the Minimum Word Count
  5. Title of Your Essay
4. Final Thoughts on Drafting

### Writing Outside of Class

Writing on a time limit while you're in class is a special situation, and it's discussed at length in the chapter on writing in class. If your essay is one that you write as homework, though, your job as a writer is easier. As long as you manage your time well, you don't have to worry about time limits. You may also be able to write on a computer, which of course makes rearranging and editing much easier.

You should follow the same steps in the writing process: planning, composing, revising, editing, and proofreading. One tip that will help you is to plan your steps to take place at different times. If you take a break between planning and composing, new and useful ideas may occur to you. If you set your essay aside once you've composed it and come back to revising in a day or two, you will do a much better job because you'll be able to see the essay more as a reader does. Finally, if you can, set it aside for another day before proofreading and editing. You'll find you catch many more mistakes than you would if you tried to proofread right after finishing it.

### References

- Jenny Crisp
- [en.wikibooks.org/wiki/Rhetoric...ition/Drafting](https://en.wikibooks.org/wiki/Rhetoric...ition/Drafting)

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## 1.5: Proofreading

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At the proofreading stage, you are sure that you have all the sentences you want and that they're in the right place. At this point, you can start cleaning up any typos or grammatical errors. If you're able to work at home or some other private place, try reading your work out loud; this helps many writers find mistakes. If you're working on a computer, print your essay out or change the font so that it looks different; sometimes that helps in spotting errors, too. Finally, try reading the essay "backward." Read the last sentence first, then read the sentence before that, etc. This can help you really focus on what the sentences actually say. When you read over something you've written in order, sometimes you unconsciously "correct" it, seeing what you meant to write instead of what is actually on the paper.

### More on Proofreading

1. Proofreading
2. Proofreading Basics
3. Proofreading Tips
4. Proofreading & Copy Editing Symbols
5. Ten Steps for Proofreading Your Work

### References

- Jenny Crisp
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Proofreading

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## 1.6: Publishing

"Publishing" does not have to mean that your work will be printed and sold in bookstores. Getting your writing ready to submit is a form of publishing as well, and there is always the opportunity to publish your own work on a blog or a similar outlet. Regardless of whether you are sending to a book printer, putting a post online for the world to read, or formatting and assembling a paper for a professor to evaluate, you want your work to present a good impression of you and your ideas.

### Formatting Styles - "Publishing" a Paper for a Professor

- MLA Formatting and Style Guide (English classes)
- APA Formatting and Style (classes in the social sciences)
- Chicago/Turabian style

### Writing for the Web

1. Writing for the Web
2. Audience and Writing
  1. Corporate Writing
3. Writing on Social Networking Platforms
  1. Your Words will follow You
4. Visual Awareness
5. Use of Video and Graphics

### More on Publishing

1. [Overview](#)
2. [Types of Publication](#)
  1. [Do-It-Yourself Print Publishing](#)
  2. [Academic Publishing](#)
  3. [Commercial Publishing](#)
  4. [Electronic Publication](#)
3. [Your Rights](#)
4. [External Links](#)

### References

- [From Rhetoric and Composition/Writing for the Web](#)
- [From Rhetoric and Composition/Publishing](#)

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## 1.7: Unstated Main Idea

Finding the unstated main idea is very similar to finding the main idea, or topic sentence, of a paragraph. The difference is that the main idea is not a sentence that you find in the paragraph or reading selection; it is unstated or implied. You might be asking why a reading selection would not contain a stated main idea, but the majority of college textbooks **do not** contain stated main ideas. The material is presented with enough clues that you can figure out the main idea of the text.

In order to understand how to find an unstated main idea, let's review some basic steps. When you are finding a stated main idea or topic sentence, you look for the **topic**. The topic is a few words (may be even one word) that may be repeated throughout the passage. You find the topic by asking "who" or "what" the passage is about. Once you have determined the topic, you move on to asking yourself what the author is saying about the topic. When the main idea or topic sentence is **stated**, you are looking for a sentence that tells what point the author is making; however, when the main idea or topic sentence is **unstated**, you must come up with a sentence that states the author's point. Let's look at an example.

*Carefully I pulled my jacket more tightly around my body. Even the thick sweatshirt I was wearing didn't help. The tip of my nose was cold, and my fingers felt too frozen to type. I looked longingly at my portable heater but didn't want to use it because I was afraid I'd leave it on by accident. Sighing to myself, I began to type but stopped when I could almost see my breath in the air. "Enough for today," I said to myself. "I'm headed home."*

Let's start with the first question: the topic. Who or what is the paragraph about?

Look at the word choice. The word "cold" is used once, but what picture is the author painting? If you said that the topic was a cold office, you'd be right. There are several clues: warm clothing, cold nose, frozen fingers, breath in the air.

Now, let's ask ourselves the key question: What is the author saying about the cold office? It appears that the author is cold enough that he/she chooses not to stay long in the cold office, so put that idea into a sentence.

The office is too cold for anyone (or the author) to stay very long.

**Remember, main ideas must be expressed in a complete sentence, so a fragment will not work when you are constructing the main idea or topic sentence.** In addition, you need to test your sentence. Is it general enough to include the points of the paragraph? Main ideas/topic sentences are general sentences as opposed to specific ones. Is it well written? Again, it must be a complete sentence. Our sentence appears to capture the point the author was making, so we have successfully created a main idea from a paragraph whose main idea was unstated.

Finding the unstated main idea takes some practice. In your textbooks, you will need to read slowly and carefully in order to fully grasp the author's point. When you write your essays, you will always state the main idea or topic sentence in your essays, but you need to be aware that your college textbooks will not always have the main idea or topic sentence stated for you. If you don't see a general sentence that sums up the points of the paragraph or reading selection, then you will need to visualize or even write down the main idea because it is unstated.

### References

- Dr. Lydia Postell

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## 1.4: Editing and Revising

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Revising, editing, and proofreading are the most important steps in college writing, but they are steps many beginning college writers are tempted to skip. Don't be one of those! Students who don't revise, edit, or proofread often turn in great ideas, but in a form that is hard to understand or that just isn't up to the standard of formal academic work. These steps don't have to be hard, but they can make a huge difference in what your work says about you and how you are perceived. They can also make a huge difference in your grades!

### Revising

Revising is the “big picture” work. Look at what you've written to see if it all makes sense. Check your logic; have you explained everything clearly and shown how it all ties together? Do you have enough details or examples to illustrate what you're trying to say and to make the essay interesting? Does each body paragraph really belong in this essay? Is there another paragraph that you really should write and include? Be sure to do these “big picture” checks before you get into the details of editing and proofreading since any big changes will mean you just have to edit and proofread again.

### Editing

Editing is a stage between revising and looking for typos. At this stage, check to be sure all your sentences are clear. Also, check the beginning of each paragraph and anywhere else that you introduce a new idea and make sure that passage flows smoothly from the passage that came before. If not, add a transitional word, phrase, or even sentence to help bridge the gap.

### More on Editing and Revising

1. Editing and Revising: One and the Same?
2. Sentence Structure
3. Editing Tips
4. Perspectives on Style
  1. Richard Lanham on Prose Styles
5. External Links

### References

- Jenny Crisp
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Editing

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## CHAPTER OVERVIEW

### 2: Essay Structure

[2.1: Introduction](#)

[2.2: Thesis/Topic/Main Idea](#)

[2.3: Paragraphs](#)

[2.4: Examples/Supporting Ideas](#)

[2.5: Modes of Organization](#)

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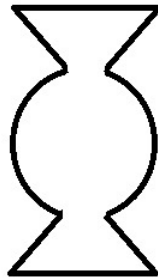
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## 2.1: Introduction

### Structure Overview

You can imagine the structure of an essay looking something like the diagram below.



*Figure 2.1.1*

At the top is your introductory paragraph, which starts broad and narrows down over the course of a few sentences to your very specific thesis statement, which is the last sentence in the paragraph.

Then, the middle or body paragraphs are "fat" with lots of specific details in each to illustrate your points.

Finally, the conclusion paragraph at the bottom starts narrowly, with a restatement of your thesis (be sure to word it differently than in the introduction - same idea, different words). Then the paragraph gets broader over the next few sentences, where you address the "so what" question. What is the broader significance of what you've been saying in the essay?

### Preposition Video



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## 2.2: Thesis/Topic/Main Idea

### Main Idea/Thesis Statement

#### Main Idea

Author: Lydia Postell

The **main idea**, as we call it in reading class, is the same as the **topic sentence** in English class. The main idea, like the topic sentence, simply states what the reading passage is about in one sentence. There are several ways to find the main idea that you can apply to topic sentences as well.

1. Find the **topic** of the selection. In order to find the topic, ask yourself **who** or **what** the selection is about. When you answer either one of those questions, you will have found the topic. Here are a couple more hints. The topic will often be a word that is repeated throughout the selection. For instance, if you were reading a paragraph about dinosaurs and how they became extinct, you would see the reason they became extinct repeated several times throughout the selection, many times using different words.
2. Another important concept about the topic is that it is always written as a few words or even as one word. Sometimes the title of the selection is the topic.
3. A third way to look for a main idea is to consider the wording. When you see words that suggest you could find the information by creating a list, then you have found the main idea sentence. Examples of these word groups are *several kinds*, *three disadvantages of*, *several reasons for*, *three causes of*, and others along these lines. These types of sentences announce the points the reading will deal with.

A couple of ideas to keep in mind: Main idea sentences take in everything in the reading passage, so when you look for a main idea sentence, be sure to look for the sentence that can take in all the points the paragraph or reading makes. Another important idea to keep in mind is that the main idea, like the topic sentence, may appear in other locations besides the beginning of an essay. While it may appear in the first two or three sentences, it may also appear in the middle or at the end of a reading selection. Don't limit yourself by looking only at the beginning! Look for the most general sentence, and then ask yourself who or what the selection is about. If you are struggling at that point, you might wish to look at the wording of the sentences to see if one suggests that a list might be coming. If so, then that is your main idea sentence.

#### Thesis Statement

In writing, a thesis statement is the most important sentence you will write in an essay. For this class, and likely for most of your college courses, it should be the last sentence – or sometimes the last two sentences – in your introduction paragraph.

The thesis statement will say something about your topic, but doesn't just state your topic. For example, you would **not** want to write

##### ✓ Example 2.2.1:

[Bad thesis]: This is an essay about how everyone should own a dog.

Instead, your thesis statement should say something that is **debatable** – that is, it should have some **attitude**. If no one could possibly argue with your thesis statement, what would be the point of writing at all? So, let's work on that thesis statement from before:

##### ✓ Example 2.2.2:

[Bad thesis]: This is an essay about how everyone should own a dog.

How could any reader argue with that? It's your essay – you know what it's going to be about. No one reading your essay knows what it's about yet – otherwise why read it? So, to give it some attitude, let's quit talking about the fact that it's an essay:

## ✓ Example 2.2.3:

[Decent thesis]: Everyone should own a dog.

OK. That's better – that thesis statement has an attitude. But, if I'm reading your essay, I still don't really know where you're going with this, do I?

That's where the other part of the thesis statement comes in: the **essay map**. An essay map gives your reader some idea of what's coming. What would you talk about in trying to convince your friends that everyone should own a dog? Those are the topics that you will explain in your body paragraphs, and they are the things you should list in your thesis statement's essay map. Here's an example:

## ✓ Example 2.2.4:

Good thesis: Everyone should own a dog because dogs provide companionship, provide protection, and provide great entertainment.

Now, *there* is a thesis statement! That one has attitude – it takes a side on the topic. It also provides a map of where the essay is going. With a thesis statement like this, readers know to expect a body paragraph about companionship, then one about protection, and then one about entertainment. Sounds more interesting than just saying “this essay will be about dogs,” huh?

## ? Exercise 2.2.1: Main idea

Select the stated main idea in the following passages.

**Passage 1**

Many people claim that they do not have time to work exercise into their daily schedules. However, exercise can be easily worked one's daily routine. For instance, one can do stretches while taking a shower. While standing in line at the grocery store, one can flex the abs or clench the rear. One can even do calf raises while talking on the phone. More ideas: try walking around the building during lunch breaks and always take the stairs.

**Passage 2**

Many parents tend to think of day-care centers as breeding grounds for colds. But new research suggests that children in day-care centers appear to develop immunity to many of the viruses responsible for the common cold. An article published in the Archives of Pediatrics and Adolescent Medicine found that children ages 6 to 11 who had been enrolled at large day-care centers as toddlers had about one-third as many colds as children who had stayed home as toddlers. Dr. Thomas Ball, one of the authors of the study, says that when children have colds as toddlers, their immune systems are learning from these experiences, and this learning will come back to protect children later in life. Such news should be reassuring to parents whose preschool children are in daycare.

**Answer**

[Main Idea - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

## ? Exercise 2.2.2: main idea

Select the stated main idea in the following passages.

**Passage 1**

One sign of pregnancy is nausea upon awakening. Other signs are increase in size and tenderness of the breasts. Still other signs include increase in the frequency of urination and an increase in the size of the abdomen. Thus, aside from pregnancy tests, a woman can sometimes recognize the early signs and symptoms of pregnancy.

**Passage 2**

Is this year's holiday season making you tired? You can easily perk up by following a few easy tips. First, get plenty of rest. Second, snack wisely. Third, keep fit. Exercise is very important during the holidays--and not just for its weight benefits. Fourth, take a relaxing bath, and finally try sharing with others.

### Passage 3

Are you confused by your holiday leftovers? Well, don't save any food that has been sitting around on your dining room table or counters for more than two hours after cooking. Do place the leftovers in the refrigerator while they are still warm. Don't waste those turkey scraps: add them to a salad or make a delicious soup. There are many strategies that you should use when dealing with holiday leftovers. You can even pool your leftovers with friends and neighbors by having an after-holiday potluck dinner.

### Passage 4

Yesterday's storm did considerable damage to our neighborhood. Many stately oaks were uprooted, and several large old pine trees crushed the roofs of at least five houses. The hail that accompanied the storm damaged all of the cars that were not under shelter, and my neighbor's home was completely demolished. And my own "detached" garage was certainly detached from its foundation. Clearly, yesterday's storm caused much destruction.

### Passage 5

Some folks think that pets are trustworthy and harmless creatures. However, it's surprising what little thieves these creatures can be. My daughter's ferret has stolen my checkbook, my calculator, my wallet, and my change purse. My officemate's dog stole a neighbor's T-bone steak right off the grill. My old dog Moonbear was known to steal freshly baked cherry pies and peanut butter cookies, while the dog that lived below us stole his master's roast one day.

### Passage 6

Lara is quite different from her sister Lisa. Lara's hair is jet black and curly, while Lisa's is blond and straight. Lara stands 5 feet 10 inches in her stocking feet, while Lisa is a mere 5 feet 2 inches (in heels!). Furthermore, Lara's complexion is olive, quite unlike Lisa's rosy hue.

### Passage 7

Many people are not good listeners. They may not even realize that they lack this skill. But almost anyone can become a better listener by being aware of certain negative listening habits. One such habit is jumping to conclusions before hearing the entire message. Another bad habit is to nod off when someone is speaking in a monotone. Turning off to speakers who are not necessarily experts is also a negative listening habit. Yet another bad habit to avoid is the habit of reacting emotionally to certain words.

### Answer

[Main Idea - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)



note

[Thesis Statement Handout](#) - handout created by UNC Writing Center

### References

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## 2.3: Paragraphs

### Structuring Your Essay

Essays in college may be very long or relatively short. Some will have five paragraphs, a structure you may have seen before. Others may have fewer paragraphs, and still others may have many more paragraphs.

All of your college essays, though, will be divided into paragraphs: groups of related sentences that develop an idea that is in turn tied back to your main topic. Each paragraph will be presented on your page separately; when you start a new paragraph you will go to a new line, and usually, indent about half an inch. In some disciplines and some online work, you may skip a line instead of indenting.

Regardless of the number of paragraphs, all of your essays should have three kinds of paragraphs:

- An introduction paragraph (or paragraphs in very long essays),
- Body paragraphs, and
- A conclusion paragraph

#### Note

[Paragraph Handout](#) - handout from OWL Writing Lab (Purdue University)

### Introduction

In an essay, you'll first present a broad overview of your topic and the position you take on that topic in an opening paragraph called the introduction. Your thesis statement, usually the last sentence in the paragraph, will state your position. Think of this as your "attitude" toward your topic. For example, if you are writing an essay about apple farming for an economics class, your topic will be apple farms. Your attitude could be many things, depending on your assignment, but perhaps you've been asked to explain in which areas of the country apple farms are most successful. Your thesis statement could be, "Although apples can be grown in most of the United States, the most successful large-scale apple operations are in Michigan and Washington State." In that case, your position, or attitude, is that Michigan and Washington are where the most successful apple farms are located.

### Body Paragraphs

Once you have an introduction and a thesis, you will need to support that thesis with some examples or evidence. You will do that in the body paragraphs that follow the introduction. An essay may have two, three, four, or more body paragraphs, but the most common number is three.

Each body paragraph will develop one point that supports your thesis, and each will contain several specific details, examples, or evidence of that point. For example, in your apple essay, in one paragraph you could make the point that the climates in Michigan and Washington State are perfect for apples. Some of your details could be the average annual temperature in the two states. You could add that those average temperatures are 44 degrees Fahrenheit for Michigan and 48 degrees Fahrenheit for Washington, perfect for growing apples.

You would also want to add at least one or two more body paragraphs to your essay, each with its own point to make in support of your thesis. In the apple essay, perhaps one would be about low land taxes in the two states and the other about the ease of getting apples to market there.

### Conclusion

The final paragraph of your essay is the conclusion. In this paragraph, you'll sum up your main points, and you may restate your thesis. However, you should avoid using the exact same words you used earlier in the paper – you have to reword, or find a different way to say, those points and that thesis.

After summing up, you should consider what the broader implications of what you have written may be. Have you (or has your reader) learned anything from the essay? Clarified thoughts on a subject? Proven a point? Determined what should be done about a problem? If so, you should indicate this in a sentence or two – this is the real "conclusion" of your essay.



### References

- Jenny Crisp

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## 2.4: Examples/Supporting Ideas

### Including Examples and Supporting Details in Your Paragraphs

One of the most important things you can do to bring your writing to life for your readers is to make sure that you provide plenty of examples or supporting details to explain the big ideas in each of your paragraphs. For example, let's say you wanted to write a paragraph supporting that thesis statement we discussed earlier about owning dogs. Remember, the thesis statement read "Everyone should own a dog because dogs provide companionship, provide protection, and provide great entertainment."

Let's work on the first body paragraph, the one about companionship. You know that you want to say that dogs are great companions. But what does that mean, exactly? You need to add details to make your point clear. So, take a minute and brainstorm some details or examples of ways in which dogs make great companions. Maybe your list would look like this:

- Greet you when you get home
- Wag tails
- Lie at your feet when you're sitting around the house
- Go for walks with you
- Keep you company when you're sick

That's a good list of some of the ways dogs provide companionship. Now, your job is to pick two or, better, three of the best to write about in that paragraph. You want to explain a little bit about each of them.

Say you think you can write something good about dogs greeting you when you get home. You could add a couple of sub-details to that detail. You could say that dogs wag their tails, jump up and down, and try to lick your hands or face when you get home. You could explain that no one other than a dog is that excited to see you every single time you get back, even if you've only been gone for five minutes.

### Practice

What could you add more detail about? Choose one of the other items from our list, and jot down a couple of things that you could say about that.



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## 2.5: Modes of Organization

### About the Modes of Organization

The first part of this book is about the stages of the writing process. Now it's time to shift gears and start thinking about the kinds of assignments you're likely to encounter in college. Each "writing mode" requires a different mode of thinking, and that's why teachers and professors often ask for different kinds of writing (they want you to think about a subject in a variety of ways). But generally, assignments will require you to apply several modes, simultaneously, to accomplish a well-rounded body of writing. Few professors beyond the first-year level of coursework require an assignment that merely focuses on description or narration; other modes are required to generate a well-rounded piece of writing that entertains, informs, and persuades (i.e., narrative, explication, argument).

Most of the time, you'll find yourself switching among all of these modes as you write. You would have a hard time, for instance, reviewing a car without spending any time describing it, and the strength of an argument depends on how well you've evaluated its evidence. What's important is that you recognize the difference between them. Many students lose points each year when they offer their teacher a description instead of the evaluation or argument called for by the assignment. Below, we break down some common writing modes, telling you their characteristics and what makes them unique, then offer examples of informal and formal writing that show them in action.

### Description

1. [What is Description?](#)
2. [Why Write a Descriptive Essay?](#)
3. Abstract Descriptions Versus Concrete Descriptions
  1. Abstract Descriptions
  2. Concrete Descriptions
4. [Similes and Metaphors](#)
5. How to Write Description
  1. [Thesis](#)
6. Examples of Sensory Words
  1. Examples of Sound Imagery
  2. Examples of Smell Imagery
  3. Examples of Touch Imagery
  4. Example of Visual Imagery
  5. Examples of Taste Imagery
7. Order of Presentation
  1. Audience
  2. Introduction
  3. Body
  4. Conclusion
8. A Second Sample Descriptive Essay
  1. First Draft
  2. Second Draft
9. External Links

### Narration

1. What is Narration?
2. What is Narrative?
3. Elements
4. Classical Arrangement



5. Modern Practice
6. Student Essay
7. Revision Hints
8. External Links

## Argumentation

Argumentation does not mean getting into a fight! See below for an explanation of argumentation (writing to persuade) in college:

1. What is An Argument?
2. Basic Argument Essay Structure
  1. Introduction
3. Body
  1. Background Information
  2. Developing Your Argument
    1. Position Method
    2. Proposal Method
  3. Dealing With the Opposition
4. Conclusion
5. Strengthening Your Argument
  1. Phrasing
  2. Objective Language
6. Sample Essay
7. The Fallacies of Argument
8. A Side Note
9. Further Reading
10. External Links

## Exposition

1. What is Exposition Writing?
  1. Types of Exposition
  2. Where Do I Begin?
    1. Find a Topic and Research
      1. Thesis
    2. Create a Sketchy Outline
    3. Start Writing
2. Structure
  1. Introduction
  2. Body
  3. Conclusion
3. Sample Exposition Assignments
4. Sample Exposition Essay
  1. Why Is This Good?
5. External links

## References

- From Rhetoric and Composition/Writing Applications
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Description
- Rhetoric and Composition/Narration

- From Rhetoric and Composition/Argument
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Exposition

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## CHAPTER OVERVIEW

### 3: Grammar and Vocabulary

3.1: Introduction

3.2: Sentence Formation (Type 1 Errors)

3.3: Mechanics (Type 2 Errors)

3.4: Proper Word Usage (Type 3 Errors)

3.5: Vocabulary, Context Clues, and Acquiring a Word

3.6: Practice Games

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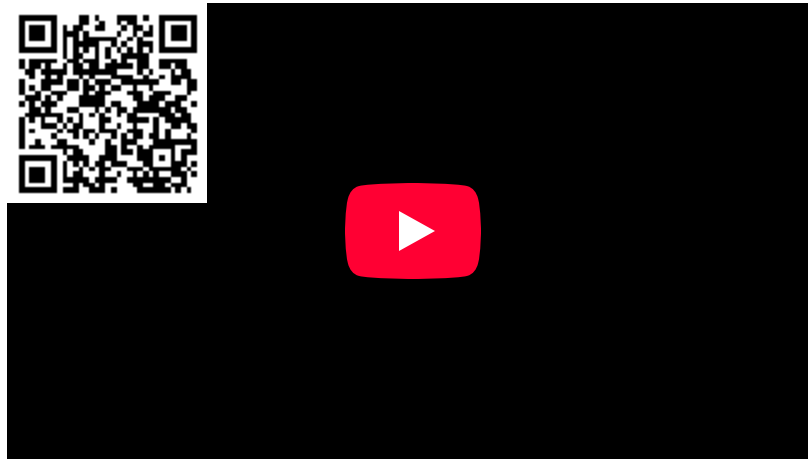
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## 3.1: Introduction

### Error Types and Grading Standards

The English Department of Dalton State College has developed a classification of grammatical and mechanical errors according to the seriousness of each error: Type I errors are the most serious, Type II are of second rank, and Type III errors are the least serious.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Type I</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Sentence fragments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Fused or run-on sentences                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Subject-Verb disagreement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Comma Splices                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Type II</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Pronoun case errors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Disagreement of pronoun and antecedent                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Verb tense sequence errors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Shifts in mood, number, person, voice of verbs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Dangling or misplaced modifiers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Faulty parallelism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Ambiguous, broad, and/or vague reference of pronouns                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Use of second person in formal essay                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Type III</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Errors in mechanics <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Capitalization</li><li>• Italics</li><li>• Abbreviations and numbers</li><li>• Commas</li><li>• Superfluous commas</li><li>• Semicolon</li><li>• Apostrophe</li><li>• Quotation marks</li><li>• Period, question mark, exclamation point, colon, dash, parentheses, brackets</li></ul>               |
| Errors in spelling and hyphenation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Errors in usage <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Diction</li><li>• Exactness</li><li>• Wordiness</li><li>• Unity and logical thinking</li><li>• Subordination</li><li>• Separation of related sentence parts, split infinitive</li><li>• Sentence variety</li><li>• Paragraphing</li><li>• Planning and drafting</li><li>• Revising and editing</li></ul> |



- Adjectives & Adverbs Handout - Handout from Utah Valley University Writing Center
- [Articles](#) - Handout from the Utah Valley University Writing Center
- [Practice with English Articles](#)
- [Preposition Practice](#)

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## 3.2: Sentence Formation (Type 1 Errors)

### About The Type 1 Errors

Whole books have been written about English grammar, and a full discussion of grammar is beyond the scope of this book. But there are a few major errors to watch out for, errors that indicate some difficulty in forming sentences. Here at Dalton State College, those are referred to as Type 1 errors, although other schools may have other names for them. This section is a short introduction to those Type 1 errors; if you have questions, please visit the Writing Lab in the Liberal Arts building (room 315).

| Type I                    |
|---------------------------|
| Sentence fragments        |
| Fused or run-on sentences |
| Subject-Verb disagreement |
| Comma Splices             |

### A Quick Guide to the Type 1 Errors

#### Fragments

A fragment is a group of words that is trying to be a sentence, but that lacks a subject, a verb, or a complete thought.

##### ✓ Example 3.2.1:

- *Because Johnny can't read.* (Incorrect. No complete thought – “Because” is the most common subordinating conjunction.)
- *The kids running through the field.* (Incorrect. No verb – remember, -ing verbs don't count, and neither do infinitives like “to be” or “to run”).
- *Ate ten Krystals all at once.* (Incorrect. No subject – who ate those Krystals?)

#### Comma Splices

This is when there are two independent clauses (subject, verb, and complete thought) with only a comma between them.

##### ✓ Example 3.2.2:

*John ate ten Krystals, then he threw up.* (Incorrect. Both have subject, verb, and complete thought, so you need at least a semicolon, not a comma, between them.)

#### Run-on Sentences or Fused Sentences

Just like a comma splice, except that there's nothing at all in between the independent clauses.

##### ✓ Example 3.2.3:

*Dr. Jones must love grammar she writes run-on sentence examples at seven in the morning.* (Incorrect. This is two clauses with subject, verb, and complete thought, just stuck together.)

#### Subject-Verb Agreement Problems

Subjects and verbs must agree in number. Verbs are “backwards”—that is, verbs have an ‘s’ on the end when they are singular (remember, nouns have ‘s’ when they are plural).

## ✓ Example 3.2.4:

- One guy runs. (Correct)
- Three guys run. (Correct)
- *Three guys runs.* (Incorrect)

The trick with subject-verb agreement is to find the subject—what’s doing the “verbing” in the sentence?

## ✓ Example 3.2.5:

- One guy, as well as his roommates, runs across the dorm parking lot. (Correct. The subject is “guy.” The stuff set off by commas and “as well as” doesn’t count.)
- One guy and his roommates run across the parking lot. (Correct. With “and,” all of them are running, so all are the subject).
- There are three apples. (“There” can be either singular or plural, depending on what it is “pointing to.” In this case, that’s “three apples,” a plural subject.)
- There is one apple. (Correct. “There” can be either singular or plural, depending on what it is “pointing to.” In this case, that’s “one apple,” a singular subject.)
- Where is my apple? (Correct. Like “there,” “where” can be either singular or plural, depending on what it’s “pointing to.”)

### Subjects, Verbs, and Independent Clauses - the Keys to the Type 1 Errors

- [Subject and Verb Handout](#) - The print handout was revised and redesigned by Maggie Escalas for the Write Place, St. Cloud State University, St. Cloud, Minnesota.
- [Independent Clauses Powerpoint](#)
- [Quiz on Identifying Independent Clauses](#)

### Run-on or Fused Sentence

1. What is a run-on sentence?
2. [Examples of run-on sentences](#)
3. Fixing run-on sentences
4. Examples of fixed run-on sentences



### Comma Splices

1. What is a comma splice?
2. Examples of comma spliced sentences
3. Fixing comma spliced sentences
4. Examples of fixed comma spliced sentences



## Fragments

- [Fragments](#)



## What Is Subject-verb Agreement

- [Subjects and Verbs Should Agree in NUMBER](#)
- [Subject and Verb Agreement](#)
- [Finding Nouns, Verbs and Subjects Quiz](#)
- [Subject and Verb Agreement quiz](#)
- [Making Subjects and Verbs Agree](#)





## Subject-verb Agreement

- [Different Look at Subject-Verb Agreement](#)
- [Subject and Verb Handout](#) - The print handout was revised and then redesigned for the Web by Maggie Escalas for the Write Place, St. Cloud State University, St. Cloud, Minnesota.
- [Subjects and Verbs Should Agree in NUMBER](#)
- [There Is vs. There Are practice](#)
- [Subject-Verb Agreement powerpoint](#)



## Lack of Agreement Between Subject and Verb Book Chapter

1. Examples
2. What is subject-verb agreement?
3. Examples
4. Other guidelines

### References

- Jenny Crisp
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Run-on sentence
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Comma Splice
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Lack of agreement between subject and verb

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### 3.3: Mechanics (Type 2 Errors)

#### Type 2 Errors

While the Type 2 errors don't have the "do or die" importance of the Type 1 errors, learning about them and avoiding them in your writing will make you sound more educated and will give what you have to say more weight. That means you'll be more convincing, and your readers will be more impressed with you and with your message. Who doesn't want that?

| Type II                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------|
| Pronoun case errors                                  |
| Disagreement of pronoun and antecedent               |
| Verb tense sequence errors                           |
| Shifts in mood, number, person, voice of verbs       |
| Dangling or misplaced modifiers                      |
| Faulty parallelism                                   |
| Ambiguous, broad, and/or vague reference of pronouns |
| Use of second person in formal essay                 |

#### Pronouns - Case, Agreement, Etc.

- [Pronouns and Pronoun Agreement](#)
- [Pronoun Agreement](#)

#### Avoiding Second Person



#### Verbs, Tense, and Tense Sequence

- [Verbs and verb tense sequence](#)

#### Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers

- [Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers](#)

#### Parallelism

- [Parallelism](#)
- [Parallel Structures Quiz](#)
- [Parallelism Group Work Quiz](#)



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## 3.4: Proper Word Usage (Type 3 Errors)

### Type 3 Errors

The Type 3 grammatical errors are less serious than the Type 1 and Type 2 errors, but that doesn't mean they aren't important. Using your words and punctuation correctly means that your reader can focus on *what* you're trying to say instead of *how* you say it. This makes a good impression of you, and it presents your ideas in the best possible light.

| Type III                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Errors in mechanics <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Capitalization</li><li>• Italics</li><li>• Abbreviations and numbers</li><li>• <a href="#">Commas</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Superfluous commas</a></li><li>• Semicolon</li><li>• Apostrophe</li><li>• Quotation marks</li><li>• Period, question mark, exclamation point, <a href="#">colon</a>, dash, parentheses, brackets</li></ul>                                                                                                               |
| Errors in <a href="#">spelling</a> and hyphenation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Errors in usage <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• <a href="#">Diction</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Exactness</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Wordiness</a></li><li>• Unity and logical thinking</li><li>• <a href="#">Subordination</a></li><li>• Separation of related sentence parts, <a href="#">split infinitive</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Sentence variety</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Paragraphing</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Planning and drafting</a></li><li>• <a href="#">Revising and editing</a></li></ul> |

### Commas

- [Commas](#)

### Which Word Is Right?

- [Working with Words: Which Word Is Right?](#)

### Working With Sentences

- [Refining Your Writing](#)

### Punctuation

1. What Is Punctuation For?
2. Is It Worth the Work?
3. What's With All the Jargon?
  1. OK, which terms do I need to know?
    1. Independent clause
    2. Dependent clause
    3. Coordinating conjunctions
    4. Conjunctive adverbs

## 2. Uses of "That"

### Colons

- [Colons](#)

### Punctuation Practice and Review

- [How to Use a Semicolon](#)
- [Comma Review](#)
- [Apostrophe Game](#)
- [Proper Punctuation](#)

### Spelling

- [Spelling](#)

### Split Infinitives



### First Person



### References

- [en.wikibooks.org/wiki/Rhetor...on/Punctuation](https://en.wikibooks.org/wiki/Rhetor...on/Punctuation)

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## 3.5: Vocabulary, Context Clues, and Acquiring a Word

### Vocabulary

One of the most important parts of reading and writing is vocabulary. You may not realize it, but the more words you know, the better your speaking and writing skills will be. College freshmen typically know around 20,000 words (need citation). Your goal is to increase this number of words so that both your speaking and reading vocabulary will grow, but what happens when you come across a word you don't know?

### Context Clues

Many times students struggle when they come across a word they have never seen. For a long time, students were told to “look it up” when they encountered a word they did not know. That is fine if you have access to a dictionary, but what if you don't? What if you are taking a test and don't recognize the word in a passage?

Context clues will help you. They are words that appear before, after, or close to a word whose meaning you might not know. All you do is keep reading and see if there is a clue to the unknown word's meaning either before, after, or close to the unknown word. Here is an example:

#### ✓ Example 3.5.1:

The gregarious student spent too much time socializing and not enough time studying.

Let's say you don't know the meaning of gregarious. Take a closer look at the sentence. What does the gregarious student do? He (or she) likes to socialize and talk to others. This type of student is definitely social, so another way to describe this student is outgoing; therefore, a gregarious student would be someone who is outgoing and who likes the company of others.

Context clues typically fall into four categories: synonym, antonym, example, and general sense of the sentence.

A synonym context clue means that there is a word in the sentence that contains the same meaning as the word you may not know. Take a look at this sentence.

#### ✓ Example 3.5.2:

The math test was arduous; students spent the entire class working on the difficult exam, and many needed extra time just to complete it.

Looking at the sentence, you'll notice there is a word that seems to describe arduous. What word is it?

If you said difficult, then you are right. Think about it. If a test requires the entire class period and students still need extra time, then that is one difficult test!

An antonym context clue means the opposite of what another word means. Here is an example:

#### ✓ Example 3.5.3:

The class completed the easy grammar test in thirty minutes, but the arduous math test took the entire class period.

Here's our word arduous again. What word in the sentence means the exact opposite? If you said “easy,” then you would be right, but how do you know if the context clue is a synonym or an antonym? Look at the wording in the sentence. It contains the word but. This word, like however and yet, shows a contrast, something that is the opposite in meaning. When you see these words used in a sentence, what comes after them will not be the same in meaning as what has come before.

Probably one of the easiest types of context clues is the example. Sentences with these types of context clues give illustrations of the difficult word. Take a look at this sentence:

Our pond is home to amphibious creatures such as frogs and turtles, who enjoy swimming in the clear water and then sunning themselves on the rocks.

If you don't know the definition of amphibious, then you might consider what frogs and turtles have in common: they swim in the water and then spend time on the rocks. Therefore, they live on the water and on the land, so amphibious creatures are at home both in water and on land. Sentences with example context clues contain words that let you know an illustration or example is coming: such as and to illustrate are two common wording patterns that are used. When you see these, you know an example or illustration is in the sentence.

Using your general sense of the sentence is also a great help when decoding words. You can look at what the sentence is saying and figure out the meaning of an unknown word. Take a look at the sentence below.

#### ✓ Example 3.5.4:

The student received an expeditious answer to her email because her instructor was online and answering student questions.

You would probably assume that since the instructor was online and answering questions that the answer to the email came quickly. If so, you would be correct.

Learning to use context clues takes time. It isn't a skill you will acquire overnight; however, always stop and think when you come across a word you don't know. Reread the sentence, and then go back and read a few sentence that lead up to the sentence you are studying. If you don't see a clue, keep reading because the context clue may be after the sentence. Just don't give up. Study the sentence and the sentences around it until you find a clue that might help you decode the word you don't understand.

## References

- Dr. Lydia Postell

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## 3.6: Practice Games

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### Verb Games

- [Grammar Bytes \(Subject-Verb Agreement\)](#)
- [Grammar Gorilla](#)
- [Frog Verbs](#)
- [To Bee or not To Bee](#)
- [Treasure Hunt](#)
- [Verb Power](#)
- [English Monstruo](#) - English Monstruo is a free app (iPad and Android versions available) containing eight games designed to help students learn verb conjugation.

### Type 1 Errors

- [Fragment Game](#) - Read through passages and use mouse to select part that is a fragment.
- [Giraffe Kart Subject-Verb Agreement Race](#) - Giraffe Karts is a multiplayer language arts game that allows students from anywhere in the world to race against each other while practicing subject verb agreement!
- [Sentence or Fragment](#) - Choose from multiple games to determine whether grouping of words is a sentence or fragment. To play games disable or bypass popup blocker software.
- [Subject-Verb Agreement](#) - Choose the correct present tense verb for each sentence.
- [Verb Subject Treasure Hunt](#) - BBC Skillwise game.

### Punctuation

- [Beat the Clock Apostrophe Game](#)
- [Possessive Apostrophe Game](#)
- [Semicolon Wars](#)

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## 4: Style, Tone, and Inference

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### Style and Tone

The information on this side of the page will help in your writing - but it's the same kinds of ideas as in reading!

- [Refining Your Writing - A Chapter on Style and Tone](#)

### Active-passive Voice

- Active-Passive Voice handout - Great handout from Utah Valley University's Writing Center.
  1. [Voice in English Writing](#)
  2. [Active and Passive Voice Sentences](#)
  3. [Use of the Passive Voice](#)
  4. The Structural Difference
- From Rhetoric and Composition/Active and Passive Voice

### Inference

The information on this side of the page will help in your reading - but it's the same kinds of ideas as in writing!

**Inference** is sometimes a difficult concept. It means to make “an educated guess” or “reading between the lines” or “drawing a conclusion”. These phrases are used because the information you are seeking is not stated. When you were in the fourth or fifth grade, you probably answered such questions as “What countries border Iraq?” or “What is the capital of Vermont?” Those questions had answers that were stated in the text you had just read. Inference, however, requires you to find answers by drawing a conclusion from the material you have read. There are clues in the material to aid you in finding the answer, but the answer is not directly stated, as it is in a literal question. An inferential question in a reading class might be “What would be a good title for the passage you just read? Here are some hints for how you might answer that question.

1. What is the topic of the passage? Remember, ask yourself who or what the passage is about. You may also look for words that are used more than once and/or words that describe the same idea, person, or thing.
2. What is the author saying about the topic? When you can answer what the author is saying about the topic, you will have the **implied main idea**, which should permit you to answer a variety of inference questions because you will know the author’s position on his/her topic.

Use these strategies when you are confronted with questions whose answers are not stated in the text. The questions may be more difficult to answer, but you can answer them with a little extra thought.

Just be aware that although most college textbooks use inference to communicate the main idea in the majority of paragraphs, you do not need to use inference to communicate you main idea in English 0098!

### References

- Dr. Lydia Postell

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## 5: Writing in Class

If you're writing in class, on a time limit, the first thing you should do is decide how much time you should spend on each step in the writing process. If you have an hour, consider spending your time this way:

- 5-10 minutes **planning**,
- 30-40 minutes **composing**, and
- 10-25 minutes **revising**, **editing**, and **proofreading**.

If you're allowed to write your essay on loose-leaf paper, try putting each paragraph on a separate page. This gives you the option of rearranging the order of your paragraphs if you need to. If you must write in a theme book and you don't want to write your introduction first, leave space for it at the beginning.

If you can, skip lines as you write. This will allow you to make neat corrections on your first draft. Some students prefer to write out a rough draft and then copy it over, and this can work very well. Since you have limited time, however, it's best to give yourself a "backup plan" in case you run out of time, and skipping lines can help with this.

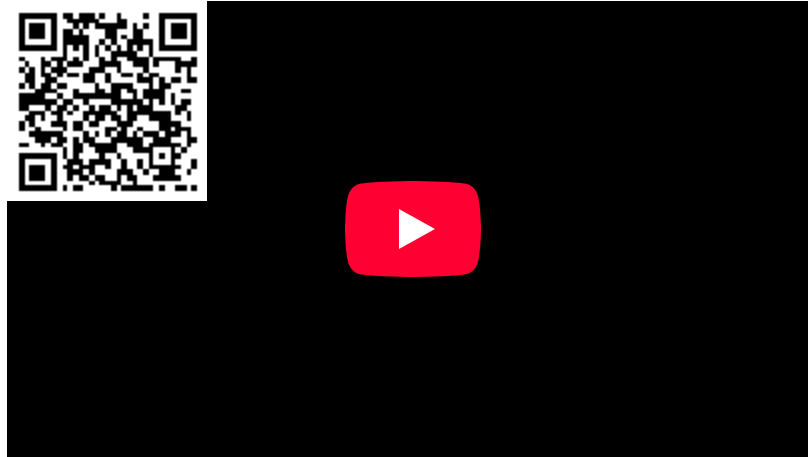
### Prewriting



### Preparing for an Essay Exam (Part 1)



## Preparing for an Essay Exam (Part 2)



### References

- Jenny Crisp

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## 6: English Language Learners

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### Overview Chapter

- [Help for English Language Learners](#)

### Games

- English Monstruo - English Monstruo is a free app (iPad and Android versions available) containing eight games designed to help students practice. It focuses on several common mistakes.
- Vocabulary Games Online - English vocabulary games for kids and ESL students: Hangman, Memory matching games, Drag & Drop games, Hidden object games and more.

### Articles and Prepositions

- [Articles](#) - Handout from the Utah Valley University Writing Center
- [Preposition Practice](#)
- [Practice with English Articles](#)

### Websites

- Common Errors in English Usage
- Purdue Writing Lab (ESL)
- Using English: A handy reference guide to major parts of speech and their usage, with bonus material for ESL instructors.
- BBC Learning English: This resource from the British channel offers all kinds of lessons and tips for learning English, including pronunciation, vocab, and grammar lessons.
- 20-Minute ESL Lessons: These audio lessons cover basic vocabulary for a variety of everyday situations, including office life.
- ESL Resource Center: This site was created for ESL teachers, so plenty of worksheets, tips, and lessons are available and work well even for those teaching themselves or trying to get ahead.
- Business English Lessons: There are dozens of key phrases on this site complete with audio clips to help ESL students practice clear pronunciation.

### Handouts

- [Articles](#) - Handout from the Utah Valley University Writing Center

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## CHAPTER OVERVIEW

### 7: Practice Exercises

The practice exercises on the following pages will help you polish your skills.

- [7.1: Comma](#)
- [7.2: Comma Splice](#)
- [7.3: Fact and Opinion](#)
- [7.4: Fragment](#)
- [7.5: Fused Sentence](#)
- [7.6: Identifying Dependent and Independent Clauses](#)
- [7.7: Logical Fallacy](#)
- [7.8: Patterns](#)
- [7.9: Proofreading](#)
- [7.10: Pronoun](#)
- [7.11: Pronoun/Antecedent Agreement](#)
- [7.12: Subject Identification](#)
- [7.13: Subject-Verb Agreement](#)
- [7.14: Supporting Details](#)

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## 7.1: Comma

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### Practice 1

1. Use a comma before a coordinate conjunction (and, but, or, nor, so, for, yet) in a compound sentence.

I am not complaining, but I am stating my opinion.

2. Commas are usually used after introductory words, phrases, and clauses.

When you leave today, remember your umbrella.

From the roof, I could see for miles.

Furthermore, I would like you to mow the lawn.

Yes, Santa Claus, there is no Virginia.

3. Use commas to set off items in a series of three or more.

Of the letters X, Y, and Z, I prefer Z.

**Insert commas as needed in the following sentences. Not all sentences need commas.**

1. Laura was tired exhausted and frustrated after such a busy day.
2. In addition she was running a temperature of 102.
3. When I was younger I was afraid of the lawnmower man.
4. My son was afraid of spiders when he was younger.
5. Sandra worked during the day and she attended Dalton State on Monday nights.
6. Laura worked nights and attended Dalton State during the day.
7. I admire your problem but I don't have any solutions to offer you.
8. If you don't mind it is my turn to have a crisis.
9. Tom Lizzy and Geoffrey drove to Playalinda and surfed all afternoon.
10. In need of water the desperate travelers searched for an oasis.
11. I was going to do the dishes but I was distracted.
12. During the bomb scare teachers held classes outside on the lawn.
13. Since it was snowing we did not enjoy having class outside.
14. After sitting in the snow for 10 minutes I began to freeze.
15. For example I enjoy reading walking and singing.

### Answer

[Comma Rules - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

1. Use a comma before a coordinate conjunction (and, but, or, nor, so, for, yet) in a compound sentence.

I am not complaining, but I am stating my rather unhappy opinion.

2. Commas are usually used after introductory words, phrases, and clauses.

When you leave today, remember your umbrella.

From the roof, I could see for miles.

Furthermore, I would like you to mow the lawn.

Yes, Santa Claus, there is no Virginia.

3. Use commas to set off items in a series of three or more.

Of the letters X, Y, and Z, I prefer Z.

4. Use commas to set off coordinate adjectives not joined by *and*.

The tired, ambitious clerk usually worked through lunch and stayed late.

Insert commas as needed in the following sentences. Not all sentences need commas.

1. In the mid-1970s I had a diabolical intelligent dog named Moonbear.
2. Moonbear was a smart quick and hungry dog.
3. He was also a very useful dog for he had the ability to scare off would-be intruders.
4. Of all his amazing tricks the one that amazed me the most was his speed.
5. When he was hungry he could move at incredible unimaginable speeds.
6. For example I once removed a freshly baked cherry pie from the oven and I put it on the center of the dining room table to cool.
7. Before I knew what was happening Moonbear jumped onto the table and began eating the hot cherry pie.
8. He had eaten half of the pie before I was able to stop him.
9. After the cherry pie incident I was more careful where I put baked goods to cool.
10. However even the top of the refrigerator was not safe from Moonbear.

### Answer

[Comma Rules - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 3

1. Use a comma before a coordinate conjunction (and, but, or, nor, so, for, yet) in a compound sentence.

I am not complaining, but I am stating my rather unhappy opinion.

2. Commas are usually used after introductory words, phrases, and clauses.

When you leave today, remember your umbrella.

From the roof, I could see for miles.

Furthermore, I would like you to mow the lawn.

Yes, Santa Claus, there is no Virginia.

3. Use commas to set off items in a series of three or more.

Of the letters X, Y, and Z, I prefer Z.

4. Use commas to set off coordinate adjectives not joined by *and*.

The tired, ambitious clerk usually worked through lunch and stayed late.

5. Use commas around words, phrases, and clauses that interrupt the flow of a sentence (and are not essential to the meaning).

I never was, by the way, a hippie.

She was, however, too tired to continue studying.

My sister, who lives in Tallahassee, is a talented artist.

Insert commas as needed in the following sentences. Not all sentences need commas. Write the rule number that justifies your use of the comma.

1. When I was in college I used to wear garlands of clover in my hair.
2. Some of these garlands would have extensions of flowers that hung to the ground.
3. My professors pretended not to notice but I suspected that they did.
4. I was however an A student and I believed my As justified my flowery whimsical appearance.
5. My reasoning wild as it may seem convinced my parents that they need not worry about me.
6. I eventually quit wearing garlands of flowers married a manipulative self-centered musician and had a son.
7. Though my son did not wear flowers in his hair he did experiment with his hair color his hairstyles and his clothing.
8. One afternoon before my night class he asked me to help him dye his blonde hair black.
9. He assured me that we would be using nonpermanent hair coloring so I helped him.
10. As you might have guessed the color of course was permanent and I ended up going to class that night with black hands and black fingernails.

### Answer

## Practice 4

1. Use a comma before a coordinate conjunction (and, but, or, nor, so, for, yet) in a compound sentence.

I am not complaining, but I am stating my rather unhappy opinion.

2. Commas are usually used after introductory words, phrases, and clauses.

When you leave today, remember your umbrella.

From the roof, I could see for miles.

Furthermore, I would like you to mow the lawn.

Yes, Santa Claus, there is no Virginia.

3. Use commas to set off items in a series of three or more.

Of the letters X, Y, and Z, I prefer Z.

4. Use commas to set off coordinate adjectives not joined by *and*.

The tired, ambitious clerk usually worked through lunch and stayed late.

5. Use commas around words, phrases, and clauses that interrupt the flow of a sentence (and are not essential to the meaning).

I never was, by the way, a hippie.

She was, however, too tired to continue studying.

6. Use commas to set off contrasted elements, geographical names, and most items in dates.

Cats, but not dogs, own themselves.

Maria was born in Rockledge, Florida, on August 16, 2002, at 10:20 p.m.

**Insert commas as needed in the following sentences. Not all sentences need commas. Write the rule number that justifies your use of the comma.**

1. My family lived in Florence Italy during my high school years.
2. After hearing her excuse I still did not believe her.
3. That's a bathing suit top not a piece of string.
4. Amelia wore sensible durable clothing.
5. Chris ran out the door jumped over the fence and raced down the road.
6. The movie was boring meaningless and confusing.
7. Maria opened her math book and then began doing problems 1 through 10.
8. When you write an essay state your thesis clearly.
9. I will walk on the treadmill or I will walk in the park.
10. Laura lived in Island Grove Florida before moving to Dalton Georgia.
11. The explanation such as it was could not be believed by any rational person.
12. I removed the blackberry pie from the oven and put it on the window sill to cool.
13. Although there are many different comma rules they can be learned.
14. I will explain them to you if you wish.
15. If you will stop nagging I will empty the trash wash the dishes and do the laundry.

## Answer

## References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.2: Comma Splice

### Practice 1

**Commas splice (CS):** A comma splice occurs when two independent clauses are joined by only a comma.

Comma splice: IC, IC.

#### ✓ Example 7.2.1:

We hiked in the Blue Ridge Mountains for three weeks, we were very tired.

### Some Easy Ways to Correct Comma Splices

1. Change the comma to a period and capitalize the next word. (IC. IC.)

**Correct:** We hiked in the Blue Ridge Mountains for three weeks. We were very tired.

2. Change the comma to a semicolon. (IC; IC.)

**Correct:** We hiked in the Blue Ridge Mountains for three weeks; we were very tired.

3. Add a coordinating conjunction before the second independent clause.

Coordinating conjunctions: and, or, but, nor, for, so, yet. (IC, CC IC)

**Correct:** We hiked in the Blue Ridge Mountains for three weeks, so we were very tired.

#### ⚠ caution

Don't simply delete the comma; this will create a run-on or fused sentence.

Directions: For each sentence below, write CS if the sentence is a comma splice or C if the sentence is correct.

- \_\_\_ 1. My apartment is too small, I have no room for my treadmill and exercise bike.
- \_\_\_ 2. I'm exhausted, however, I will go to school anyway.
- \_\_\_ 3. Tom opened his freezer, then he noticed that two cans of beer had exploded.
- \_\_\_ 4. Although I understand the definition, comma splices still confuse me.
- \_\_\_ 5. A comma splice occurs when two complete sentences are joined only by a comma, I need to remember that rule.
- \_\_\_ 6. It's means "it is" or "it has," its' is always incorrect.
- \_\_\_ 7. I hiked for five hours yesterday, consequently I am too tired to go hiking again today.
- \_\_\_ 8. For example, I like to read suspense novels, email my friends, and play cards with my daughter.
- \_\_\_ 9. My son Geoffrey plays drums in band called Talent Scam, and he likes to surf at Playalinda Beach.
- \_\_\_ 10. Some people value money and material possessions, others value love and family.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Comma Splice Practice 1](#)

### Practice 2

Directions: For each sentence below, write CS if the sentence is a comma splice or C if the sentence is correct.

- \_\_\_ 1. Don't go in there, you will be horrified.
- \_\_\_ 2. She was, however, tired and worn out.
- \_\_\_ 3. First, I must go shopping, then I have to decide what to fix for dinner.

- \_\_\_\_\_ 4. Maria is running a temperature of 102, therefore, she should not go to school today.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 5. Although she had a fever, Maria still wanted to go to school.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 6. Mary Grace Thompson lives with her divorced father, for her mother ran away with the local tax collector.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 7. Every day Frank brings calm to other people's catastrophes, however, now catastrophe has struck his life.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 8. I was sick last week, consequently I've fallen behind in my work.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 9. Not only had her goals changed, she spent less time with her friends.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 10. She knew that at home her endless horse talk was boring, yet she wouldn't stop long enough for her father to ask about her symptoms.

**Answer**

[Answer Key - Comma Splice Practice 2](#)

**Practice 3**

Directions: For each sentence below, write CS if the sentence is a comma splice or C if the sentence is correct. Correct any comma splices using one of the methods described above.

- 1. Every year I make New Year's resolutions, for example, I will try to drink more water.
- 2. Every year, however, I seem to fail at my resolutions.
- 3. I did not want to fail this year, consequently, I changed my resolution.
- 4. I finally understood that goals needed to be specific, so I modified my goal.
- 5. This year I will drink four glasses of water every day, this goal is specific and measurable.
- 6. While this is a measurable goal, however, four glasses of water a day is not sufficient.
- 7. I don't care, at least this year I will be successful.
- 8. Today I found out my bad cholesterol is a little high, therefore, I will reduce my fat intake.
- 9. I was reading the dictionary today, and I read that a "chrisom child" is a child who dies in its first month, this struck me a very sad.
- 10. Perhaps I should stop reading the dictionary, on the other hand, it is useful for correcting my spelling.

**Answer**

[Answer Key - Comma Splice Practice 3](#)

**Practice 4**

Directions: For each sentence below, write CS if the sentence is a comma splice or C if the sentence is correct. Correct any comma splices using one of the methods described above.

- 1. My son was a very healthy child, however, my daughter is often sick.
- 2. My daughter, however, has never broken a bone.
- 3. Geoffrey broke his wrist by falling from a seesaw, he broke his arm by falling from a ladder.
- 4. The seesaw accident was not his fault, however, he should not have been on the ladder.
- 5. He was supposed to be watching his little sister, instead he was hanging lights for an end-of-year party.
- 6. I let him invite his friends to the party, I did not know he had 200 friends.
- 7. The party was a nightmare for me, furthermore, it bothered the neighbors.
- 8. There were teenagers everywhere, for example, they filled the kitchen, the living room, the deck, and even the loft in the garage.
- 9. At 10:00 p.m. I asked these teens to go home, by midnight there were only 12 "friends" left.
- 10. All twelve asked to spend the night, and five of the 12 were girls.

**Answer**

[Answer Key - Comma Splice Practice 4](#)

## Practice 5

Identify and correct any comma splices in the following email entitled "Rules of Chocolate."

Chocolate is a vegetable. How so? Chocolate is derived from cacao beans, beans are vegetables. In addition, sugar is derived from either sugar CANE or sugar Beets, both are plants, which places them in the vegetable category. Thus, chocolate is a vegetable, you should have at least five servings of vegetables a day.

To go one step further, chocolate bars also contain milk. Milk is a healthy dairy product, therefore, chocolate bars are a health food.

Chocolate covered raisins, cherries, orange slices, and strawberries all count as fruit, consequently, you can eat as many as you want.

If you've got melted chocolate all over your hands, you're eating it too slowly.

Consider this problem. How do you get 2 pounds of chocolate home from the store in a hot car? The solution is easy, eat it in the parking lot.

If you are trying to lose weight, here is a delicious diet tip. Eat a chocolate bar before each meal, it will take the edge off of your appetite, and you will eat less. If calories are an issue for you, store your chocolate on top of the refrigerator. Calories are known to be afraid of heights, they will jump out of the chocolate to protect themselves.

If I eat equal amounts of dark chocolate and white chocolate, is that a balanced diet? Don't they actually counteract each other?

Are you having trouble accomplishing your daily goals? Here's a suggestion for you, put "eat chocolate" at the top of your list of things to do today. That way you will get at least one thing done!

### Answer

[Answer Key - Comma Splice 5](#)

### References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.3: Fact and Opinion

### Practice 1

Determine whether the following sentences are facts, opinions, or a mixture of fact and opinions. Then, check your answers against the key.

1. Marijuana should be legalized to reduce the effects of the current economic crisis.
2. The death penalty should be abolished because it's just too expensive.
3. A California lawmaker Monday introduced legislation that would legalize (and tax) pot there.
4. Last year, in an effort to cut costs, probation and parole agencies in Arizona, Kentucky, Mississippi, New Jersey, and Vermont sadly reduced or dropped prison time for thousands of offenders who foolishly violated conditions of their release.
5. President Barack Obama said Tuesday night that the country must now act "boldly and wisely" to take charge of its future.
6. Everyone is entitled to his or her own opinion.
7. All opinions are equally relevant.
8. Bruce Springsteen wrote "Thunder Road," a classic song of escape.
9. My car, which has only 10,000 miles on the odometer, will last another six years.
10. A city in beautiful north Florida, Tallahassee is the state's capital.

### Answer

[Fact & Opinion - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

Determine whether the following sentences are facts, opinions, or a mixture of fact and opinions. Then, check your answers against the key.

1. America's tax laws are very confusing.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
2. Using the IRS e-file makes doing your taxes easier and faster.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
3. When you itemize deductions on your tax return, you cannot deduct both state income taxes and general state sales taxes.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
4. In 2008, more than 92 million Americans filed their taxes electronically.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
5. It's unfair that the IRS limits educator expense deductions to those who teach in kindergarten through grade 12.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
6. It's not safe to file your tax return electronically.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
7. It makes no sense to allow only students in Midwestern disaster areas to deduct the cost of their textbooks when they file their income tax.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
8. According the U.S. tax laws, course-related books and supplies are not qualified Educational expenses except for students who live in Midwestern disaster areas.  
a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion
9. The maximum Hope education credit has rightly been increased to \$2,500 for most taxpayers.

a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion

10. We should not have to pay taxes.

a. Fact b. Opinion c. Mixed Fact and Opinion

### Answer

[Fact & Opinion - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

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## 7.4: Fragment

### Practice 1

Identify any fragments in the following "sentences." Keep in mind that a sentence must have a subject, have a verb, and express a complete thought.

Remember that the "ing" form of a verb is not a true verb unless it is preceded by a helping verb.

Remember that the "to" form of the verb (the infinitive) is not a verb.

1. Martha Stewart not dining with us this Thanksgiving.
2. I'm telling you in advance.
3. So don't act surprised.
4. Since Ms. Stewart won't be coming.
5. I've made a few small changes.
6. Our sidewalk will not be lined with homemade paper bag luminaries.
7. After a trial run.
8. It was decided that, no matter how cleverly done, rows of flaming lunch sacks do not have the desired welcoming effect.
9. Once inside, our guests noting that the entry is not decorated with the swags of Indian corn and fall foliage that I had planned to make.
10. Instead, I've gotten the kids involved in the decorating by having them track in colorful autumn leaves from the front yard.
11. The mud was their idea.
12. The dining table not covered with expensive linens, fancy china, or crystal goblets.
13. However, since this is Thanksgiving.
14. We will refrain from using the plastic Peter Rabbit plate and the Santa napkins from last Christmas.

### Answer

[Fragment - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

Identify any fragments in the following "sentences." Keep in mind that a sentence must have a subject, have a verb, and express a complete thought.

Remember that the "ing" form of a verb is not a true verb unless it is preceded by a helping verb.

Remember that the "to" form of the verb (the infinitive) is not a verb.

The following selection was adapted from Terry Kay's *To Dance with the White Dog*.

1. On the day after his father was buried.
2. James drove to the cemetery in the pink-blue glaze of dawn.
3. The plot was still crowded with wreaths of flowers.
4. Flowers with bright, colorful faces and ribbon sashes.
5. And the white, mica-sand covering of the ground was pockmarked where people had stood for the gravesite services.
6. And where chairs had been placed for the family.
7. James stood at the foot of the graves of his parents and his brother.
8. A brother he had not known.
9. A brother dead before his own birth.
10. And stared at the shadowed sand mounds.
11. Nothing was as permanent.
12. He turned and looked across the cemetery.
13. His father had said the white dog would be there.
14. To look for the white dog at sunrise.

15. His father had said the white dog was his mother.
16. His father was wrong; there was no white dog at the cemetery.
17. Suddenly, a chill struck his neck and raced across his shoulders.
18. He could feel his heart racing.
19. His eyes scanning the cemetery.
20. James walked into the plot, between the grave mounds of his mother and father, and he knelt.
21. Then he saw them.
22. Across the chest of sand on the grave of Robert Samuel Peek.
23. He saw the paw prints.
24. Prints so light that they could have been made by air.

### Answer

[Fragment - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

## Practice 3

Identify any fragments in the following "sentences." Keep in mind that a sentence must have a subject, have a verb, and express a complete thought.

Remember that the "ing" form of a verb is not a true verb unless it is preceded by a helping verb.

Remember that the "to" form of the verb (the infinitive) is not a verb.

1. If you understand what a fragment is.
2. Understanding, however, does not always come easily.
3. Taking the time to practice.
4. Studying long hours and seeking feedback from instructors and tutors.
5. To understand fragments is my goal.
6. Wanting to understand, but not able.
7. Since this sentence begins with a subordinate conjunction.
8. It might be a fragment.
9. For example, blueberry muffins with plenty of hot butter.
10. Driving down the road late one Sunday afternoon.
11. Seeing the Northern Lights for the first time in my life.
12. Second, the folks that drive while asleep.
13. Third, the blind-blinkers.
14. Finally, the folks that never use their turn signals.
15. All of these drivers annoy me.

### Answer

[Fragment - Practice 3 Answer Key](#)

## Practice 5

Identify any fragments in the following "sentences." Keep in mind that a sentence must have a subject, have a verb, and express a complete thought.

Remember that the "ing" form of a verb is not a true verb unless it is preceded by a helping verb.

Remember that the "to" form of the verb (the infinitive) is not a verb.

1. February, a great day in the history of Dalton State College.
2. The announcement of the return of intercollegiate athletics.
3. Because our students say athletics is important.
4. Voting for an athletics fee to improve campus life for future students.

5. Wanting to participate in the full college experience.
6. Derek Waugh will be the college's new athletics director.
7. Launching men's and women's teams at the same time.
8. Although I enjoy college sports.
9. Dalton State's mission is to provide broad access to quality higher education for the population of Northwest Georgia.
10. Dalton State's QEP title is "Getting on the 'Write Path.'"

### Answer

[Fragment - Practice 4 Answer Key](#)

### References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.5: Fused Sentence

### Practice 1

A fused sentence (or run-on) occurs when two independent clauses are joined without punctuation or without a coordinating conjunction.

Fused sentence: Independent clause independent clause.

#### ✓ Example 7.5.1:

At first I wanted to be a doctor now I don't.

Some easy ways to correct a fused sentence are as follows:

1. Add a period after the first independent clause and capitalize the next word. (IC. IC)

#### ✓ Example 7.5.2:

At first I wanted to be a doctor. Now I don't.

2. Add a semicolon after the first independent clause. (IC; IC)

#### ✓ Example 7.5.3:

At first I wanted to be a doctor; now I don't.

3. Add a comma and a coordinating conjunction after the first independent clause. (IC, CC IC)

#### ✓ Example 7.5.4:

At first I wanted to be a doctor, but now I don't.

**Directions:** For each sentence below, write FS if it is a fused sentence or C if it is correct.

- \_\_\_ 1. Many young athletes want to play for professional leagues few actually succeed.
- \_\_\_ 2. I lost my train of thought did you find it?
- \_\_\_ 3. Laura was exhausted from hours of study however she made it to class on time.
- \_\_\_ 4. Dolphins have killed sharks they never attack humans.
- \_\_\_ 5. The shrimp was served with its head still on as a result, Mary lost her appetite.
- \_\_\_ 6. Mary's sister, however, ate the shrimp anyway.
- \_\_\_ 7. In later years, Mary developed a shrimp allergy, but her sister still enjoys shrimp.
- \_\_\_ 8. The roads were covered with ice therefore school was cancelled.
- \_\_\_ 9. The typewriter hummed loudly; consequently, I turned it off.
- \_\_\_ 10. If you understand what a fused sentence is, you will be able to proofread for them in your papers then you will be less likely to make such a mistake.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Fused Sentence Practice 1](#)

## Practice 2

Directions: For each sentence below, write FS if it is a fused sentence or C if it is correct.

1. My Aunt Grattis lives in a mansion on the Delaware River in a small town called Andalusia.
2. She is extremely fussy about her furniture for instance children under 12 cannot sit on her antiques.
3. One of the problems college students face today is credit card debt credit-card companies offer cards to students who don't have jobs.
4. Credit card companies can be unscrupulous one even offered a pre-approved card to my eight-year-old daughter.
5. I went to the walk-in clinic because I was feeling ill in fact, I had walking pneumonia.
6. Dr. Weeks's nurse called today she said that I need to exercise more often.
7. Since I am too busy studying grammar rules, I have no time to exercise the nurse did not think that was a very good excuse.
8. She is probably right I should exercise more.
9. Do you think that typing at the computer counts as exercise?
10. My fingers are certainly getting a good workout today I have been typing for three hours.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Fused Sentences Practice 2](#)

## Practice 3

Directions: For each sentence below, write FS if it is a fused sentence or C if it is correct.

1. According to MSNBC, a New Jersey major wants forecasters held responsible for dire predictions forecasters who predict blizzards should be held accountable for their predictions.
2. Major Richard Bowe wants to know if the forecasts of heavy snow and blizzard conditions were mistakes or a deliberate attempt to generate ratings.
3. He suggests errant forecasters ought to be held responsible for losses by businesses and others who lost money by listening to the forecasts.
4. A spokesperson from the National Weather Service notes that forecasts are judgments based on available information they are not any kind of guarantee.
5. The storm was originally forecast to wreak havoc on the entire northeastern portion of the United States however, the storm left most major cities unscathed.
6. Washington, Philadelphia, and New York took much less of a beating than first predicted the storm came nowhere near to living up to its hype.
7. Snow accumulations from the storm, which began battering the region late Monday, ranged from 18 inches to 30 inches.
8. Red-faced forecasters were scratching their heads over how they could be so wrong in their predictions.
9. Forecasters had grappled with conflicting computer models before predicting that New England would be the hardest-hit area.
10. Forecasters thought the storm would paralyze the entire coast they predicted it could be the worst blizzard in 35 years.
11. Those fears were not realized the storm dissipated.
12. Many areas got slush and rain instead of snow.
13. "Our models aren't perfect we'd be the first to admit that," said the director of the National Centers for Environmental Predictions.
14. I am not sure why those folks are complaining would they have been happier if there had been a disaster?
15. Things could be worse forecasters warn another storm could come as early as Friday.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Fused Sentence Practice 3](#)

## Practice 4

Determine whether any of the following sentence are fused. Correct those that are.

1. One day in the late summer, Frog was not feeling well.
2. Toad said, "Frog, you are looking quite green."
3. "But I always look green," said Frog "I am a frog."
4. "Today you look very green even for a frog go to bed and rest."
5. Toad made Frog a cup of hot tea Frog drank the tea.
6. It's not easy to sit at the computer and make up examples of fused sentences.
7. The sun is shining the world is all aglow.
8. This is the last day of spring break, and I'm sitting here at this computer trying to think of fused sentences.
9. I must be out of my mind everyone else is at the beach.
10. But it's too cold for the beach; furthermore, it's too far to drive.
11. Adjectives modify nouns by adding to their meaning adverbs modify verbs and other adverbs.
12. Nouns are words that name persons, places, things, or abstractions.
13. The comma is the most widely used punctuation mark there is much variation in its usage.
14. I slipped on the wet floor as I ran across the kitchen.
15. I cannot prepare for the seminar because I have misplaced my glasses.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Fused Sentence Practice 4](#)

## Practice 5

Identify and correct any fused sentences.

1. The severe weather warning did not deter some travelers traffic on I-75 was not as heavy as usual.
2. The sky turned black the rain fell in torrents.
3. Many drivers turned on their flashers because visibility was poor.
4. Since I could no longer see the road, I pulled off at the first exit.
5. There was no gas station at the exit I joined the many cars that were pulled off on the side of the road.
6. I was almost out of gas, so I turned off my engine.
7. When the rain slackened, I got back on the interstate I drove to the next exit.
8. I'm glad that I kept driving I later learned that a tornado touched down near where I had been parked.
9. It destroyed several homes fortunately no one was hurt.
10. Now that you have completed questions one through nine, you should check your answers.

### Answer

[Answer Key - Fused Sentence Practice 5](#)

## References

Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.6: Identifying Dependent and Independent Clauses

### Practice 1

An independent clause, also known as a simple sentence, includes a subject and verb and expresses a complete thought.

#### ✓ Example 7.6.1:

Juliet, a border collie puppy, prefers to **chase** apples and pears.  
Subject Verb

A dependent clause has a subject and verb, is introduced by a subordinate conjunction or a relative pronoun, but does not express a complete thought. A dependent clause is not a complete sentence.

#### ✓ Example 7.6.2:

*Because* the heavy rains **flooded** the entrance to the subdivision.  
Sub. Conj. Subject Verb

#### ✓ Example 7.6.3:

*After* Laura carefully **read** the assigned chapter.  
Sub. Conj. Subject Verb

Determine whether the underlined word groups are dependent clauses, independent clauses, or not a clause.

1. Although it was raining, Maria went for a jog at Civitan Park.
2. Brianna eats chocolate whenever she gets a poor grade in math.
3. After the flood, the family moved into a temporary shelter.
4. While walking at the park, John saw a raccoon eating potato chips.
5. Students enrolled in bachelor's and associate's degree programs must pass the Regents' Test as a graduation requirement.
6. Students who fail to show up for the Regents' test must enroll in the Regents' remediation courses.
7. When you finish your homework, please take the dog for a walk.
8. After Juan completed the assignment, he swam laps at the gym.
9. Christa left home at 4:00 a.m. since she had to drive to Atlanta for a meeting.
10. Before completing the assignment, Evan decided to eat a quick lunch.

### Answer

[Identifying Dependent and Independent Clauses - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

Determine whether the underlined word groups are dependent clauses, independent clauses, or not a clause.

1. Juan continued playing although he injured his knee.
2. I thought that the offer was too good to be true.
3. While I was scrubbing the floors, Juliet was watching television.
4. Although tired and grumpy, Laura agreed to babysit for her sister-in-law.
5. Inspired and energized, Sean solved the case of the missing energy drink.
6. While driving home from spring break, Maria saw a tornado touch down.
7. People who drink and drive should be arrested.
8. Ever since my daughter purchased a ferret, I have noticed that authors describe their bad guys as ferret-like.
9. Such descriptions are not fair to ferrets.
10. Since I could not go to the Pancake Breakfast, I gave away my tickets.

## Answer

[Identifying Dependent and Independent Clauses - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

## References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.7: Logical Fallacy

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### Practice 1

1. "You are saying she was killed because she was immoral, and she was immoral because she was killed!" (from Anne Perry, *The Cater Street Hangman*, pp. 71-72)
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. no error
2. You will either complete all of your assigned readings for this class, or you will fail this course.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
3. You should never schedule your child's dentist appointments during school hours. If you do, your child will miss more and more classes. Before you know it, your child will be an elementary school drop out.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. slippery slope
  - d. false alternatives
4. New Yorkers are so rude! I went to New York City last summer, and two taxi-cab drivers almost ran me down.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. slippery slope
  - d. false alternatives
  - e. careless comparison
5. I do not like writing because I do not like to write.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
6. Students are just like customers: both groups are paying for a product, and both are always right.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
  - e. personal attack
7. We must stop the University System from raising tuition. If we don't, the System will also begin raising technology fees; then the System will increase parking fees. Soon no one will be able to afford college.
  1. hasty generalization
  2. circular reasoning
  3. false alternatives
  4. slippery slope
  5. personal attack
8. You can't believe anything Professor Loca says concerning child development. After all, he has no children of his own.
  - a. hasty generalization

- b. circular reasoning
  - c. personal attack
  - d. careless comparison
  - e. slippery slope
9. Having leadership shows others that you can be a great leader. (student essay)
- a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison

### Answer

#### [Logical Fallacy - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

1. You should reduce your fat intake because eating too many fats is bad for you.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. no error
2. “We will move forward together or not at all.” President Barack Obama
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
3. We should not pass a bill that bans the sale of alcohol on Sunday. We such a bill were passed, then lawmakers would eventually pass a bill banning the sale of alcohol after midnight. Soon we would be back to Prohibition.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. slippery slope
  - d. false alternatives
4. Florida Gator fans drink too much. When I was at the Florida-Georgia game, I saw at least ten Gator fans who were intoxicated.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. slippery slope
  - d. false alternatives
  - e. careless comparison
5. We must not pass any more gun control laws or we will all be blown up by terrorists.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
6. Exercising is just like eating candy. Just as eating a little candy won’t hurt you physically, exercising a little won’t hurt you. But too much exercise, like too much candy, will make you sick to your stomach.
  - a. hasty generalization
  - b. circular reasoning
  - c. false alternatives
  - d. careless comparison
  - e. personal attack

7. We must stop the University System from increasing the requirements to receive the Hope Scholarship. If we don't, the System will make it more and more difficult for students to afford college, and eventually, only the rich will be able to attend the college of their choice.
- hasty generalization
  - circular reasoning
  - false alternatives
  - slippery slope
  - personal attack
8. You can't possibly believe Mr. Smith's testimony in the money laundering trial. Mr. Smith once plagiarized an essay when he was in college.
- circular reasoning
  - personal attack
  - careless comparison
  - slippery slope
9. Dieting is useless because everyone knows that diets don't work.
- slippery slope
  - circular reasoning
  - false alternatives
  - careless comparison
10. Either we start making teachers pay into their own pensions or the state government will collapse.
- hasty generalization
  - circular reasoning
  - false alternatives
  - careless comparison

### Answer

#### [Logical Fallacy - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

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## 7.8: Patterns

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### Practice 1

1. Because the television was too loud, I was not able to concentrate on my studies, and consequently, I did not do well on my algebra test.
  - a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. simple listing
  - d. cause & effect
2. Semiconductors are sample devices that use materials that are halfway between the conductors' characteristic of few outermost shell electrons and the table, inert materials with eight valence electrons.
  - a. comparison
  - b. definition
  - c. simple listing
  - d. classification
3. My dog Moonbear was very different from my dog Frankie.
  - a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. time order
  - d. cause & effect
4. There are several chores that I do every day: wash the dishes, make the beds, and take out the trash.
  - a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. simple listing
  - d. time order
5. To make a pasta face, cut a large circle 1 foot in diameter from cardboard. Next, cut 2 large holes 1.5 inches apart in the center of the circle. Then, Cut 2 squares from the plastic packaging to fit over the eye holes and tape onto the back of the mask. Next, paint the front of the mask white and leave to dry.
  - a. classification
  - b. description
  - c. time order
  - d. simple listing
6. As we penetrated deeper into the heart of the old city, the narrow winding streets took on the character of a maze, composed of dirty crumbling walls and shuttered windows. The latticed balconies jutting out from the upper stories of the tall old houses cut off the sunlight, so that we walked through a dusty shade. (Elizabeth Peters, Lion in the Valley)
  - a. comparison
  - b. description
  - c. simple listing
  - d. cause and effect
7. There are several varieties of movies that I enjoy: musicals, suspense thrillers, and comedies.
  - a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. simple listing
  - d. description
8. His father and his brother had been involved in the illegal antiquities trade; both had met terrible ends the previous year. (Elizabeth Peters, Lion in the Valley)
  - a. comparison

- b. description
  - c. contrast
  - d. cause and effect
9. The *Harry Potter and the Sorcerer's Stone* DVD offered several special features: never before seen footage, self-guided tour of Hogwarts, theatrical trailers, and scene access.
- a. simple listing
  - b. description
  - c. time order
  - d. cause and effect
10. *Polarity* denotes the relative electrical charge of one point in an electrical circuit "with reference to" another point.
- a. simple listing
  - b. description
  - c. definition
  - d. classification

### Answer

[Patterns - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

1. "The simplest and most obvious explanation," Emerson continued angrily, "is that Ronald tried to kill his brother. An act of purely private villainy, Peabody. Why Ronald should hate Donald I do not know, but there are several possibilities: an inheritance, or rivalry for the hand of the young lady, for instance. People do kill people for the most ridiculous reasons". (Elizabeth Peters, *Lion in the Valley*)
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. cause and effect
  - d. time order
2. The grand palette of the heavens was streaked with colors no early painter could achieve, savage-glowing bronze and gleaming crimson, indigo and rose and soft blue-gray. (Elizabeth Peters, *Lion in the Valley*)
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. definition
  - d. description
3. Three types of shoppers are certainly annoying: the aisle blockers, the coupon commandos, and the bargain hunters.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. classification
  - d. simple listing
4. For those who are forgetful, the following tips can make the holiday season just a little easier. One month before the Christmas or Jewish holidays, buy and mail holiday cards. Three weeks before, mail gifts to anyone you won't be seeing in person. Two weeks before, tip service providers that you use regularly. One week before, start planning the menu.
- a. simple listing
  - b. time order
  - c. cause and effect
  - d. definition
5. A growing body of scientific research reveals that alcohol use by pregnant women can result in birth defects in unborn children.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast

- c. time order
  - d. cause and effect
6. The *fight-or-flight response* is the body's reaction to a stressor by confrontation or avoidance.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. time order
  - d. definition
7. Alcohol abuse is similar to drug abuse in several ways.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. definition
  - d. cause and effect
8. Dr. T. Berry Brazelton has identified 14 key parenting points for families with young children.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. classification
  - d. simple listing
  - e. cause & effect
9. There are four types of therapeutic approaches to mental disorders: insight-oriented therapy, behavior therapy, group therapy, and biological therapy.
- a. comparison
  - b. contrast
  - c. classification
  - d. simple listing
  - e. cause & effect
10. The orange, red, and golden leaves glistened in the bright morning sun and shimmered in the soft breeze.
- a. time order
  - b. comparison
  - c. description
  - d. definition

### Answer

#### [Patterns - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

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## 7.9: Proofreading

### Practice 1

Read the following paragraph and determine whether each sentence is correct, is a fragment, has a subject/verb agreement error, includes a comma splice, or is a fused sentence. No sentence includes more than one error.

1. When I was younger, I had a number of "accidents" with my cars. 2. Not accidents in the traditional sense. 3. For example, as I was driving home from work one day, I smelled smoke. 4. I pulled over to the side of the road then I looked under the hood. 5. Seeing nothing alarming, I got back into my car and continued driving, however, the scent of smoke became even stronger. 6. So strong that I pulled over to the side of the road again. 7. Still seeing nothing unusual, I got back into my car this time it filled up with smoke. 8. A passing motorist stopped to offer his help. 9. He pulled back the carpet from under the accelerator, the carpet burst into flames. 10. Noticing a jug on my front seat, he asked what were in it. 11. When I told him it was iced tea, he poured the tea onto the fire. 12. Putting out the fire before it could do more damage. 13. another incident happened several years later. 14. My sister and I was driving to the beach. 15. Smoke started coming from the cassette player, quickly the smoke filled the car. 16. Forcing us out of the car. 17. It seems my husband had wired the cassette player incorrectly. 18. A fact that is not particularly surprising. 19. I no longer have either car, I no longer have that husband.

#### Answer

[Answer Key - Proofreading Practice 1](#)

### Practice 2

Read the following paragraph and determine whether each sentence is correct, is a fragment, has a subject/verb agreement error, includes a comma splice, or is a fused sentence. No sentence includes more than one error.

1. The Internet can be a great source of information for students who are doing research, however, the information on the Internet is not regulated. 2. Anyone can post information that is intentionally or unintentionally inaccurate or misleading anyone can create his or her own Web page. 3. There is information on aging, information on cancer, information on health, and information on weight loss. 4. The Alcoholics Anonymous Web site and the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism site provides information related to alcohol abuse. 5. Looking for information on pregnancy and childbirth? 6. Not hard to find on the Internet. 7. Labor and Birth Resources (a good Web site) provide information on the different types of pain medications available to mothers. 8. Interested in weight loss? 9. Try Overeaters Anonymous. 10. Another good site that include assessment tools is Cyberdiet.

#### Answer

[Answer Key - Proofreading Practice 2](#)

### Practice 3

Read the following paragraph and determine whether each sentence is correct, is a fragment, has a subject/verb agreement error, includes a comma splice, or is a fused sentence. No sentence includes more than one error.

1. There is a number of risk factors associated with cardiovascular disease. 2. Some of these factors cannot be changed. 3. Increasing age, male gender, and heredity is a few. 4. According to health sources, six risk factors are related to our own choices in lifestyle, these include smoking, activity level, cholesterol level, blood pressure, weight, and diabetes. 5. Many smokers believe that if you have smoked for years, there is no benefit in quitting the damage has been done. 6. This belief, however, is incorrect. 7. According to the American Heart Association, one's risk of heart disease declines rapidly after one quits smoking. 8. Another changeable factor related to heart disease is lack of regular exercise. 9. Physical activity, including walking, swimming, or jogging, help lower cholesterol levels and encourages weight loss. 10. Another risk factor for heart disease is stress. 11. Especially unresolved stress over an extended period of time. 12. Those who cannot cope with stress are more likely to develop harmful lifestyles that contribute to heart disease, they may smoke, become inactive, or eat fatty foods. 13. Take control of your heart. 14. Before it is too late.

#### Answer

## Practice 4

Read the following paragraph and determine whether each sentence is correct, is a fragment, has a subject/verb agreement error, includes a comma splice, or is a fused sentence. No sentence includes more than one error.

1. Some people eat the strangest food items for breakfast. 2. Like roast beef, mashed potatoes, and candied yams. 3. My uncle, who has traveled to China, South America, and Africa, like to eat elephant ears (the plant!) in a coconut cream sauce. 4. My brother Bill likes hot fudge sauce on his grits, my sister likes catsup on her eggs. 5. My father on rare occasions eat cold pepperoni pizza. 6. My former neighbors back in Island Grove, Florida, likes to eat swamp cabbage and heart of palm. 7. Other people serve the strangest foods at parties. 8. For instance, chocolate covered turkey! 9. At my brother Peter's caroling party, he and his wife served an odd variety of finger foods. 10. There was octopus in a lemon butter sauce, squid in a marinara sauce, and oysters in an apricot sauce. 11. A former boyfriend seasoned pancakes in the oddest ways he liked to throw in pinches of cloves, cumin, and nutmeg. 12. Thinking he was a creative genius. 13. No one ate his pancakes. 14. Not even his dog.

### Answer

## Practice 5

Read the following sentences and determine whether each sentence is correct, is a fragment, has a subject/verb agreement error, includes a comma splice, or is a fused sentence. No sentence includes more than one error.

1. The story of the first two years, two months, and two days in the life of a modern Southern marriage.
2. This book is dangerous, it is one of those rare books that causes fits of uncontrollable laughter.
3. In the book The Heart of a Distant Forest, Andrew Lachlan meets a woman he had loved, they soon begin seeing each other.
4. At one point in the novel, Lachlan writes, "It is hard for me to write my hands shake so."
5. A novel written with insight, poetry, beauty, and passion.
6. A book meant to be read again and again.
7. The night became cold, Laura was glad that she packed an extra blanket.
8. Laura would not sleep well that night she would ache from the damp and freezing air.
9. Sometimes my life seems like a novel, I am a character lost in a series of confusing subplots.
10. Living out my life in third person singular.
11. Reading and walking was all she loved.

### Answer

## References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.10: Pronoun

### Practice 1

| Nominative (Subject)<br>Case |                     |             | Objective Case       |        |
|------------------------------|---------------------|-------------|----------------------|--------|
|                              | Singular            | Plural      | Singular             | Plural |
| 1st Person                   | I                   | we          | me                   | us     |
| 2nd Person                   | you                 | you         | you                  | you    |
| 3rd Person                   | he, she, it,<br>who | they<br>who | him, her, it<br>whom | them   |

- The nominative case is used when the pronoun is the subject of a verb.
- Also, use a subject pronoun after any form of the verb "to be."
- The objective case is used when the pronoun is the direct object of a verb or the object of a preposition.

**Choose the correct case for each pronoun in the sentences below.**

1. Maria and (her, she) laughed and talked well into the night.
2. (Him, He) and I just don't seem to get along very well these days.
3. It was (her, she) who tied up the computer for three hours.
4. Cora handed Tom and (I, me) the employment applications.
5. Between you and (I, me), pronoun case can be very confusing.
6. Among the applicants were Tom and (me, I).
7. It was (he, him) and Colleen who solved the problem with my scanner.
8. The vice president will select (you or I, you or me) to serve as acting chair.
9. Between Joseph and (him, he), there really isn't much of a choice.
10. As for my cousin and (I, me), we will not be attending the dinner.
11. That certainly is not (he, him) sitting in the first row of the theater.
12. I gave the note to Laura, (who, whom) gave it to Phil.
13. I gave the left over fudge to Tom and (she, her).
14. Leonardo wrongly believed that (she and Tom, her and Tom) would take the blame for him.
15. (Whom, Who) did you say would be attending in my place?

**Answer**

[Pronoun Case - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

**Choose the correct case for each pronoun in the sentences below.**

1. My sister is taller than (I, me).
2. After hearing his sister explain the fight she had had with husband, Jim exclaimed, "the person who should apologize is (him, he)!"
3. The winner of last night's raffle was (her, she).
4. My long-time friend went to dinner with my husband and (I, me).
5. (Her, She) and her friends went to see *Hamlet* on Landis Green.
6. The teacher gave (we, us) students extra credit for an optional term paper.
7. Between you and (I, me), that outfit looks ridiculous on her.
8. He was not as angry as (them, they).
9. Please give the leftovers to Paul and (she, her).

10. My sister Lisa and (me, I) take a trip to Panama City every spring.
11. Lisa enjoys shopping more than (me, I).
12. The child Laura was most concerned about was (her, she).
13. When will you start listening to your mother and (I, me)?
14. I think that (you and him, you and he) are more similar than you think.
15. She selected Troy (who, whom) she thought could do the job right the first time.

### Answer

[Pronoun Case - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

### References

- Dr. Mary Nielsen, Dean of the Dalton State College School of Liberal Arts.

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## 7.11: Pronoun/Antecedent Agreement

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### Practice 1

Remember:

1. Neither, either, and each are singular.
2. Words ending in "one," "body," and "thing" are also singular.
3. A collective noun is singular if the group acts as one unit, plural if the members of the group act as individuals.

Directions: Choose the correct pronoun in the following sentences.

1. Each of the daughters followed (her, their) mother's footsteps.
2. Neither of the actors could remember (his, their) lines correctly.
3. Everyone complained that (his/her, their) food was cold.
4. Neither of my sisters remembered to purchase (her, their) tickets.
5. Late in the evening, the jury finally reached (its, their) verdict.
6. The captains of both teams forgot the words of wisdom that (his, his or her, their) coaches had given the night before the championship.
7. Every student should proof (his or her, their) essay for Type I errors.
8. All of my brothers earned (his, their) degrees from Florida State University.
9. Almost everyone was surprised when (he or she, they) heard the news.
10. Everybody on the voyage complained that (he or she, they) were suffering from food poisoning.

**Answer**

[Pronoun/Antecedent Agreement - Practice 1-Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

Directions: Choose the correct pronoun in the following sentences.

1. Neither Clarissa nor Aleah wore (her, their) own dresses to the prom.
2. Someone in your ENGL 1101 class called and left (his, their) phone number.
3. McDonnell-Douglas recently published (its, their) report on the newly improved Tomahawk missile.
4. One of the cashiers thinks that (her, their) boss has been transferred to a different location.
5. Many of the students at Dalton State College find that school pressures affect (his or her, their) relationships at home.
6. Each of the candidates gave (his or her, their) speech at the Civic Center.
7. Having an obsessive-compulsive personality, Laura likes to have everything in (its, their) place before she goes to sleep at night.
8. Either of the women who parked illegally will soon find that (her, their) car has been towed.
9. Either my brothers or my uncle will fail to purchase (his, their) tickets in time to receive a discount.
10. Either my brother or my uncles will fail to purchase (his, their) tickets in time to receive a discount.

**Answer**

[Pronoun/Antecedent - Practice 2 Answer Key](#)

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## 7.12: Subject Identification

### Practice 1

#### Finding the Subject

- The subject of the sentence usually answers the following question: Who or what is this sentence about?
- The subject is typically a noun (person, place, animal, or thing) or a pronoun (e.g., *I, he, she, we, you, they*).
- The subject may be a *gerund* (*ing* form of a verb: *running, swimming, studying*).
- The subject may be an *infinitive* (*to* form of a verb: *to run, to swim, to study*).
- A sentence may have two or more subjects (compound subjects).
- *There* and *here* are never the subjects of sentences.

Underline the subjects in the following sentences.

1. Today's weather forecast is for partly cloudy skies with temperatures in the upper 80s.
2. A stray thunderstorm is possible through the early evening.
3. There has not been any rain in weeks.
4. The sound of rain would be like music to my ears.
5. Tropical depression Barry brought five inches of rain to Melbourne, Florida.
6. According to the WeatherChannel.com, the United States has the largest number of tornadoes worldwide.
7. The tornado warning for Leon County was cancelled just moments ago.
8. We will not need to go to the basement after all.
9. Cleaning the basement and emptying the garbage are my youngest brother's chores.
10. Here are Tom and Rita.
11. Surfing is dangerous during a tropical depression.
12. To see a tornado form was the tornado hunter's strongest desire.
13. I do not share that desire.
14. Feeling exhausted, Laura lay down on the floor under the ceiling fan.
15. To lose weight requires tremendous effort and willpower.

#### Answer

[Subject Identification - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

### Practice 2

Underline the subjects in the following sentences.

1. For five homeless teenagers, surfing became a way to enjoy life, at least for a week, at Playalinda Beach.
2. However, next week, an upcoming launch of the space shuttle will close the beach.
3. Reading enables children to experience places beyond their reach.
4. All too frequently, your cover letter and resume can keep you from getting a job.
5. According to Kate Lorenz, there are ten ways to ruin a resume.
6. Writing in first person and using passive language are particularly troublesome.
7. Failing to proofread can also be fatal.
8. You should avoid flashy formatting and tiny font sizes.
9. To teach eighth graders requires enormous energy.
10. Quitting work early, Laura stopped at Kroger to buy something to cook for dinner.
11. The Writing Lab is a great place to prepare for final exams.
12. To succeed in college, you should attend every class session and read all assigned material.
13. Laughter is the best medicine.
14. To err is human.
15. To forgive is beyond her abilities or desires.

Answer

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## 7.13: Subject-Verb Agreement

### Practice 1

Choose the correct verb in the following sentences. Click on the answer key at the end of the practice.

1. There (is, are) an empty cup and a paper bag on the floor.
2. My sister as well as two of my brothers (lives, live) in Florida.
3. The professor, together with twenty-five students, (is, are) happy that the term was almost over.
4. My grandmother and grandfather (look, looks) alike.
5. Either my brothers or my younger sister (is, are) owed my thanks.
6. One of her six children (run, runs) five miles every day.
7. Each of the students (spend, spends) six hours studying for classes every day of the week.
8. Neither of the boys (is, are) willing to study during the weekends.
9. As a result of the conflict, there (is, are) bloodshed and chaos.
10. Do you think that the manager and our supervisor (understands, understand) the problem?
11. Neither my sister nor my brothers (is, are) planning to drive down from New York for my seventh marriage.
12. One of my shoes (is, are) missing.
13. Christopher or Laura (email, emails) me almost every day.
14. Maria's regular salary together with tips (are, is) just enough for her to survive.
15. Under my son's bed (was, were) three *Rolling Stone* magazines.

#### Answer

[Answer Key - Subject/Verb Agreement Practice 1](#)

### Practice 2

Reminders: Each, everyone, everybody, and one are singular pronouns.

Watch for prepositional phrases that separate the subject from the verb (of the \_\_\_\_, with the \_\_\_\_). The verb should agree with the subject of the sentence, not the object of the preposition.

**Directions:** In each of the following sentences, select the appropriate form of the verb.

1. One of my old fillings (need, needs) to be replaced.
2. The young widow with her five small children (want, wants) to get on the bus.
3. In the back of the closet (is, are) some old paperback novels you might like to have.
4. The Chevy with the blue tinted windows (need, needs) washing.
5. Geoffrey (doesn't, don't) have time to finish his work.
6. Along the river's edge (is, are) found many different kinds of wild flowers.
7. Every one of the employees (seem, seems) ready for a vacation.
8. Each of the Academy Award winners (was, were) well-paid.
9. Some of the sweaters that are supposed to be new (have, has) torn seams.
10. One of the clerks (do, does) much better work than the other one.
11. The serving platter with the flowers and vines on it (is, are) pretty.
12. Neither my brothers nor my sister (is, are) going to the beach with me this weekend.
13. Laura, together with Sally and Jon, (is, are) going to Port St. John this weekend.
14. The plumber with his young helper (was, were) at the door only 10 minutes after Maria called.
15. Neither the scouts nor the scoutmaster (was, were) found until the second day of the search.

#### Answer

[Answer Key for Subject/Verb Agreement Practice 2](#)

### Practice 3

Directions: In each of the following sentences, select the appropriate form of the verb.

1. A seer, so my friends tell me, (predict, predicts) events or developments.
2. The seer, together with three other psychics, (plans, plan) to make a number of startling predictions.
3. These predictions, including one about how well you will do on this practice, (is, are) not to be believed.
4. My sister, along with her husband and my parents, (is, are) driving to a wedding this weekend.
5. Inside my refrigerator (is, are) a can of Diet Pepsi and an old English muffin.
6. One of my brothers (was, were) in Atlanta last weekend.
7. The teacher as well as her students (believe, believes) that practice makes perfect.
8. However, I believe that perfect practice, including long drills, (is, are) the key to success.
9. Neither of the two politicians (expect, expects) to lose the race.
10. Neither Senator Smith nor her administrative assistants (return, returns) phone calls.
11. Neither her administrative assistants nor Senator Smith (return, returns) phone calls.
12. Each of the twins (has, have) some unusual habits.
13. The first type of driver that I find annoying (is, are) the speeders.
14. She is one of the students who always (answer, answers) correctly.
15. Sara is the only one of the students who always (answer, answers) correctly.

#### Answer

[Answer Key for Subject-Verb Agreement Practice 3](#)

### Practice 4

Directions: In each of the following sentences, select the appropriate form of the verb.

1. There (is, are) a pebble and some sand in my shoe.
2. A list of Dalton State College course offerings (is, are) posted on the college webpage.
3. Details of the accident (was, were) not released.
4. The stereo, together with the phone and the CD layer, (go, goes) dead during electrical storms.
5. Maria and Stephanie (play, plays) Dream Phone on Saturday mornings.
6. Here (is, are) Tom and Jerry.
7. Directions for the recipe (is, are) on the back of the box.
8. In the safety-deposit box at the bank (is, are) is an extra key to my house and some important papers.
9. All of the cookies (taste, tastes) stale.
10. In the locker room (is, are) a few old weights.
11. Neither that Internet site nor the article from Time magazine (was, were) helpful to my research.
12. All of the snow (has, have) melted.
13. Larissa or her cousins (is, are) coming to Dalton to visit.
14. Either the articles on the Internet or the one in library (seem, seems) to have relevant information.
15. The article, together with the web pages, (is, are) too much for me to read today.

#### Answer

[Answer Key for Subject-Verb Agreement Practice 4](#)

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## 7.14: Supporting Details

### Practice 1

**Determine the number of major details in the paragraphs below. It is useful to identify the topic sentence and to look for transition words that suggest addition (such as *first, second, third, moreover, also, in addition, furthermore*).**

1. According to WebMd, there are a number of symptoms associated with hypothyroidism. One common symptom is the inability to tolerate cold. People with hypothyroidism feel cold more intensely and often wear light sweaters, even during the summer. Another symptom is feeling tired throughout the day. In addition, individuals with this disease often experience hair loss. (Some women find that they never have to shave their legs again.) Yet another symptom is dry skin. Perhaps most problematic is modest weight gain. People with undiagnosed hypothyroid disease often gain weight even when they do not overeat.
2. Mystery fiction comes in many varieties, each appealing to different groups of readers. First, there is the "classic" mystery. Classic mysteries include works by Agatha Christie, Edgar Allan Poe, and Sir Arthur Conan Doyle and allow the reader an equal opportunity to solve the crime. Another category is the hard-boiled variety. Often considered distinctly American, this variety includes tough, solitary detectives who live in a world gone wrong. Then there are police procedurals. These stories offer a step-by-step look at the personnel and methods used in the investigation of a crime and typically include police officers as protagonists. Finally, there is the contemporary cozy, which is similar to the classical style.
3. For a novel to be classified as a "contemporary classic mystery," it must include many of the following characteristics. For one thing, there must be a puzzle to be solved by both the reader and the protagonist. In addition, the detective, usually a reluctant amateur, is the hero. Next, the investigation of the crime must be the central action or plot of the story. Furthermore, the victim of the crime should be someone who will not be terribly missed. Contemporary classic writers must also follow the rules of fair play. That is, all clues should be accessible to the reader and no new evidence should be included when the villain is unmasked.
4. The 1970s saw a number of changes in the mystery fiction publishing world. One change was the importance of regionalism. Novels need not be set in an English country village or on the mean streets of some huge city. Another change was inclusion. Females were no longer excluded in the world of the private eye. Novels of this time period also saw changes in ethnic and racial representation. For instance, James Patterson introduced the African-American detective Alex Cross, and Rabbi David Small and Father Dowling both had crimes to solve. In addition, novels of the 1970s showed increased specialization. Series might focus on horse racing, sports agents, cats, and even antique prints.
5. The writer S. S. Van Dine forbade certain tricks in the writing of mystery and detective fiction. First of all, a writer could not use a seance to trick the guilty party into confessing. The detective also could not use a word association test to determine guilt. Another forbidden trick was the use of phony fingerprints. Nor could writers have a character use a dummy to establish an alibi. Van Dine viewed such tricks as violating the rules of fair play.
6. Father Ronald Knox also offered his own rules for detective fiction. No more than one secret room or secret passageway was allowed. The criminal had to be introduced fairly early in the story. Supernatural forces were also not permitted. Knox also believed that the detective could not be the villain. Perhaps his strangest rule was that no Chinamen could be featured in a story.
7. The Dalton State Portal has many useful features. It includes access to BANNER. Here students can check their grades or register for courses. The Portal also includes campus announcements. These may inform students of new courses or events offered through the Fine Arts series. The Portal's "bookmark" feature is particularly useful. With a few simple steps, the user can have access to the Weather Channel, the Hummingbird Migration Web site, or even the *Daily Citizen* online. Moreover, the Portal offers "tabs". These tabs can take interested students to the Roberts Library Web site or to their DSConnect course page. Finally, the Portal offers access to campus email.
8. According to *Research Methods in the Social Sciences* (Frankfort-Nachmias and Nachmias), using personal interviews is often more advantageous than using questionnaires sent through the mail. Personal interviews offer greater flexibility. For instance, during an interview, the interviewer can clarify questions that might be misunderstood. In addition, personal interviews typically yield a better response rate. Researchers cannot control how many questionnaires are thrown away as junk mail, but they can control the numbers of people they eventually interview. Personal interviews also provide fuller information. The interviewer can observe facial expressions and spontaneous reactions that a mailed survey cannot provide.
9. However, using personal interviews to conduct research is not without disadvantages. The text *Research Methods in the Social Sciences* (Frankfort-Nachmias and Nachmias) notes that personal interviews are more expensive than mailed questionnaires. For

example, travel costs to interview a single subject for a study may be far more expensive than the cost of a postage stamp. In addition, personal interviews are subject to interviewer bias. During a face-to-face interview, the interviewer may inadvertently send nonverbal signals to the interviewee that might affect his or her responses. A final drawback of personal interviews is the lack of anonymity. If the subject matter is sensitive or controversial, the interviewee could feel too uncomfortable to answer truthfully.

10. American workers change jobs for a variety of reasons. Promotion is one typically positive reason for changing jobs. Relocating is also a common reason for a job change. Sometimes workers relocate to help out an aging parent; others relocate for health reasons. Layoffs are also responsible for many job changes. Employees who find themselves laid off will often take any job available. And of course, some individuals are forced into a new line of work when they are fired.

## Answer

### [Supporting Details - Practice 1 Answer Key](#)

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## 8: Readings

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### Readings in Each Mode of Essay

- [Readings: Examples of Essays](#)

### Kirkman Reader

- Kirkman Reader - Free readings and videos for students enrolled in freshman composition. The essays and videos are organized by pattern, point of view, and theme.

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